

● *BITTER WITHY: Settled as a trio*

To Morroco and Bock with the Withy

by JERRY GILBERT

SAFARI VILLAGE, Morocco — the complete antithesis of the strait-jacket holiday, or to use the brochure's cant "if you're a sour-puss we don't want you".

For the past six months eminent British folkies have ventured into the hinterland, picking their way through the mosques and mosquitos, golden deserts and black scorpions. Their task: to keep the home fires burning in the hearts of British holiday-makers.

Colin Scot, Noel Murphy, Derek Brimstone, Jon Betmead, Tudor Lodge and the Foggy Dew-O are just a few of the artists who have gone on safari, and on the penultimate week of the season it was the lot of an Edinburgh trio called Bitter Withy, accompanied by yours truly.

MIXED

Bitter Withy are the central figures in this burlesque, modern day folk tale and will be properly introduced later.

The music of Morocco is a mixed brew indeed — and the musicians a motley collection. So if you happen to be one of the pre-packed holiday-makers whisked across to the North African coastal village of Asilah by a BAC 1-11 jet, one of the first guys you are likely to encounter is Driss — home grown musician of integrity. And should you happen to be an aficionado of that beautiful intrinsic Eastern instrument, the oud, then stay away from Driss because his dominant recurring theme is none other than "Oh My Darling Clementine".

On the other hand for eine kleine nachtmusik we need turn no further than Taffy, the camp's security officer, who begins his nocturnal vigil around midnight, summons forth a set of bagpipes and plays on towards the picturesque Moroccan dawn.

BAGPIPES

A word about Taffy. He is one of those rare people who can survive with life's barest essentials, and in order to spend a pleasurable Moroccan holiday it is necessary to cultivate a similar village demeanour. Taffy was originally discovered drifting aimlessly through Marrakesh playing his bagpipes, and was promptly hauled into the camp and given a position of rare responsibility. He still drifts around aimlessly with a ubiquitous presence, an omnipresent ear-to-ear grin and the inextricable bagpipes, whilst he is also renowned for his horticultural achievements and his herbaceous goodies harbour the best pot plant Morocco can offer.

But we can now forget about Taffy (exeunt) for he was merely a diversion and plays no further part in the story.

Bitter Withy's six nights' residency took place in the Sahara Bar, which mechanically disseminates prodigious bottles of a dubious ale called Super Bock. By the second week of your holiday you will be having nightmares about Super Bock which far outstrip the gloomy prospects of sharing your bed with deadly scorpions and paralysing caterpillars. Suffice to say that for any self-respecting alcoholic, Safari Village is tantamount to being locked away in a concentration camp.

But for Lesley Hale, Tich Frier and Andrew Ramage, jr. the week was a huge success although Andrew was constantly lamenting the fact that coming from a long line of drinkers, the climate was not at all suited to him. At the end of the week camp officials considered that Bitter Withy had been the most successful of all the acts to go on safari, and this is a tribute to the spirit and enthusiasm with which they approached their task.

Indeed their maturity belies a youthful appearance and the fact that they were still feeding new material into the act on the final night and responding to "impossible" requests attests to their ability as entertainers. For it was scarcely a folk audience they were playing to.

APPROACH

Attractive Lesley Hale is a charming focal point in the band whilst Tich and Andy, whose propensity offstage was somewhat rakish and rampant, channelled such revelries to their songs during the evenings when they were positively assiduous and fastidious in their appearance and presentation of their act.

Bitter Withy have now passed through all the necessary phases of development during their four years together, and have devised a compromising approach in which professionalism and entertainment are always the priorities. At the same time their eclectic selection of material in an extensive repertoire enables them to showcase their humour, ribaldry, serious unaccompanied ballad singing, delicate harmonies and tidy instrumental work.

When I spoke to Tich he informed me that the group had now settled as a trio after a series of upsets which on more than one occasion had resulted in Lesley leaving the group. "The first time it was due to a massive personality clash but this sort of thing happens quite regularly," Tich quipped.

"Before the group formed I was singing a bit with Davy Johnston and also working solo. I first met Andy in a folk club in Edinburgh, and he knew three chords on the guitar and I didn't know any."

COMEDY

After Lesley had left the band Tich and Andy spent nine months working as a duo and changed radically from singing completely straight traditional material to presenting something of a comedy act. "It was all good education," Tich recalled. "Lesley came back and we went a wee bit straighter after that but we've kept up the entertaining bit ever since we started; it's opened up our eyes considerably doing the comedy stuff and realising that there's more to folk than just A. L. Lloyd or the Coppers or whatever."

The group are now so resilient that they can break down their act into solo spots with Lesley singing one of her Joni Mitchell songs, Andy trying to sing his tongue-twister "The Fly" in less than 28 seconds, and so on.

The result was that last August Bitter Withy made an album for which a release deal is still being negotiated. Meanwhile they are now extending their instrumental scope to incorporate Tich's banjo and Andy's fiddle, and at the same time Lesley is writing songs of her own and the group are hoping to feature more of these.

ORGANISED

"As far as we're concerned, if a song serves a purpose or it's good then we do it," Tich says philosophically. "But it is all down to better organised gigs for us now because we've been over-exposed in Scotland and some gigs we're just not suited to. We'd like to get away more next year."

And to give you some idea of the way Bitter Withy's itinerary works, immediately after their return from Morocco they began a week's work in Carlisle alongside Hamish Imlach.

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Mike the musical comic strip

IF YOU happen to live in Notting Hill then there's a good chance that you'll appreciate Mike Absalom's many tales of intrigue as related on his new Vertigo album. Constable McClaggan appears to be the central figure and invariably becomes the subject of Mike's pun-a-line humour as he embarks upon his track by track excursion in search of the dreaded substances.

As Mike says: "You either like what I'm doing or you hate it — there's no half measures"; and whilst I can't profess to be entirely in the former category there is no doubt that one of the folk scene's long serving artists is injecting a bit of much needed humour into the record business. And to his great credit he has succeeded in discovering a market for his music which takes him almost entirely off the folk circuit.

COLLEGES

The fact that his name doesn't appear regularly on the folk club rosters as it used to has no drastic implications — it simply means that Mike is confining the majority of his work to colleges and universities, and in view of the fact that he has set up home in both Earls Court and Whitby, he no longer has the problem of interminable travelling to and from gigs.

Mike has now made three albums over a long period of time, but this is his first for a major company. "I'll be doing two albums a year for the next three years," he explained. "The next one will be a continuation of this one — there'll be more of McClaggan because he's a very popular character and I get applause whenever I mention his name.

"I do tend to write a lot — I try new songs out on an audience and if they don't get a laugh then I chuck them away; when I'm in London I spend every afternoon writing songs," Mike told me.

He explained that the colleges had always been his main venues even before the circuit became popular — and now he writes songs with the colleges in mind.

"I used to offend a lot of people when I sang rude songs, and it was when I stopped doing this kind of material that I did less and less folk club work.

"I like to think of myself as a sort of musical comic strip" says Mike, who has travelled all over the world and is something of an expert on languages.

"McClaggan was the name of one of the school bullies and the songs are caricatures with him failing most of the time.



● *MIKE ABSALOM*

PATTER

"I enjoy writing for a specialist market trying to carve out my own little niche. A lot of my work is reading The Times from cover to cover every morning, and I'll change the themes of my songs as I feel the scene around me changing. Off the cuff stuff and patter is very important in my act, and obviously I won't go on writing about drugs for ever.

"It's easier to change on the college scene than the folk scene where you tend to get type-cast, but as far as my material goes at the moment, the pills ar are coated with a liberal dose of sugar so that people laugh no matter what their attitudes are". — JERRY GILBERT

folk albums

reviewer: jerry gilbert

VARIOUS ARTISTS: "SONGS OF CEREMONY" (TOPIC 12T197).
THIS IS the ninth volume in the Caedmon Folk Songs of Britain series, and whilst it may be invidious to select one aspect of folksong from the best and most comprehensive series of British folksong ever collected, I feel that this latest volume is the most fascinating of the lot. Several interesting comparisons can be drawn between the various wassails, for instance, for the album features Charlie Bate singing Phil Tanner's "Gower Wassail", Harry and Walter Sealy with the "Somerset Wassail Song" and Bate and the Truro Wassail Bowl Singers with the "Cornish Wassail Song". Other songs of particular interest on the album are Peter Jones singing "The Holly And The Ivy", The Coppers with "The Twelve Days of Christmas", Charlotte Smith and William Payne with their versions of "The Bitter Withy", John Partridge's "Cherry Tree Carol", The Coppers' "Shepherds Arise", The Antrobus Soul Cakers with the "Cheshire Souling Song", Group of Boggans with "John Barleycorn and Helston townspeople with band on "Hal-an-tow".

DEBUT

VARIOUS ARTISTS: "TAKE OFF YOUR HEAD AND LISTEN" (RUBBER LP 001).
AN EXCELLENT debut album from a new label based in Newcastle. This is a sampler and an introduction to some of the artists we can expect to hear on forthcoming releases by Rubber. By any standards it's a mighty fine sampler, and at 99p you can't go far wrong. Best known artists on the album are the JSD Band and Brethren (who are now Lindisfarne). Alan Hull does two numbers with the band, including the Lindisfarne hit "We Can Swing Together", and also "Where Is My Sixpence?" A remarkably high standard is maintained throughout.

LOCAL

VARIOUS ARTISTS: "THE WIDE MIDLANDS" (TOPIC 12TS210).
AS A sort of successor to "Deep Lancashire", this regional volume, centred around the West Midlands, has turned out extremely well. Roy Palmer, with assistance from the Birmingham and Midland Folk Centre, is the man responsible for producing and organising this album which features a variety of local artists including the Singing Tradition, Peter Coe and Christine Richards, Tom Langley, Dave Rogers, Pam Richards, John Rose, Paul Hooke and others. The stories and songs related on the album present a good picture of the Central Counties, and at the same time they are presented not in an academic manner but in an entirely entertaining way. There's some particularly good singing from Graham Langley, Roy Palmer and the Singing Tradition and a couple of entertaining stories from Tom Langley.

VARIOUS ARTISTS: "MORE GRAND AIRS FROM CONNEMARA" (TOPIC 12T202).
SECOND VOLUME of Gaelic Irish music from Topic featuring John McDonagh, Patrick Keane, Thomas Naughton, and Festy Conlan on whistle. Topic have packaged the album with an accompanying booklet which contains transcriptions in Irish and also transcriptions into English along with background information on the tracks. The album is particularly notable for the singing of John McDonagh, and the airs of Festy Conlan, many of whom he learnt from his mother. Among the outstanding tracks are "The Lament Of The Three Marys", "Thorny Ledge", "The Yellow Bittern", "The Cursed Kerryman" and "The Little Black Rose".

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THURSDAY

ANDOVER Country Bumpkin: **ROCK AND ROLL ALLSTARS**
BATH RAF Calum: **WILD ANGELS**
BIRMINGHAM Alhambra Rock Theatre: **LOU REED**
BIRMINGHAM College of Food: **LIGHT FANTASTIC /NECROMANDUS**
BLETCHLEY Wilton Hall: **CHICORY TIP**
BRISTOL Art Centre: **DAVE CARTWRIGHT**
BRISTOL Old Granary: **HEADS HANDS & FEET**
CARDIFF Top Rank: **LINDISFARNE / GENESIS / RAB NOAKES**
CHELTENHAM Town Hall: **CURVED AIR**
● To everybody's amazement Curved Air have found a new lease of life. Go see them again and watch out for Kirby, potentially a new guitar superstar. See also Front Row Reviews page.
COVENTRY Warwick University: **EDDIE 'GUITAR' BURNS / DOCTOR ROSS / JOHNNY MARS**
DONCASTER Side Saddle Country Club: **VANITY FARE**
EAST KILBRIDE Olympia Ballroom: **SHAKIN' STEVENS**
GOSPORT Bay House School: **STEVE TILSTON**
GUILDFORD Civic Hall: **SYD LAWRENCE ORCHESTRA**
HANLEY Place: **SCAFFOLD**
HANLEY Top Rank: **DR. MARIGOLD's**
HEMEL HEMPSTEAD Pavilion: **SOLID GOLD CADILLAC**
HULL Malcolms: **CLIMAX CHICAGO**
IPSWICH Cop Rock House: **MONTANAS**
LANCASTER Dukes Playhouse: **DOCTOR ROSS**
LEEDS City Hall: **SOFT MACHINE**
LEICESTER Polytechnic: **JONATHAN KELLY**
● A mild Irishman who turns into an enthralling solo performer on stage. Remember his set at Bickershaw? He's made even more friends since.
LEICESTER Rosie's Blues Club: **CHAMPION JACK DUPREE**
LIVERPOOL Cavern: **FOCUS**
● Now here's a beautiful band. Believe all the good things you hear about them because they're true. Focus are professional, tight, inventive, technically brilliant and — wheeeeew — guitarist Jan Akkerman is amazing.
LIVERPOOL St. George's Hall: **ELO**
LONDON Battersea Town Hall: **RARE BIRD**
● Free gig.
LONDON EDMONTON Sundown: **MANFRED MANN'S EARTHBAND / SAMMY**
LONDON FINCHLEY Torrington: **RONNIE SCOTT /MIKE CARR / TONY CROMBIE**
LONDON FULHAM Lord Palmerston: **SCARECROW**
LONDON Marquee: **JONESY**
LONDON Royal Albert Hall: **"UP COUNTRY PACKAGE TOUR"**
LONDON Speakeasy: **SUZI QUATRO BAND**
LUTON Odeon: **FOUR TOPS/THELMA HOUSTON**
MANCHESTER Concorde: **WILD WALLY**
MANCHESTER Hardrock: **TEN YEARS AFTER**
● See Saturday.
MIDDLESBROUGH Town Hall: **SMITH PERKINS & SMITH**
NEWCASTLE City Hall: **STEELEYE SPAN / AMAZING BLONDEL**
NEWPORT Vine Club: **COLIN BLUNSTONE BAND**
NORTHAMPTON Fantasia: **SNAKE EYE**
NORWICH Jacquard Club: **AL STEWART**
● The voice of bedpsit land society is back once more as a solo artist now his band has disbanded. Songs to listen out for are "Manuscript" — and a new one, "Nostra-Damus".
SCARBOROUGH Technical College: **BUDGIE**
SOUTH HARROW Birds Nest: **JOHNNY WALKER MOTOWN SHOW**
SOUTHPORT Floral Hall: **CLIFF RICHARD**
WATFORD Wall Hall College: **MIKE ABSALOM**
WARWICK University: **EDDIE "GUITAR" BURNS**
WEALDSTONE Railway Hotel: **ROCK CIRCUS**

FOLK

BOGNOR REGIS Club Rex, Esplanade: **JON BETMEAD**
BRIGHTON Richmond Hotel, Richmond Place: **PETE & JEAN**
CAMELFORD County Primary School: **DANCE GROUP**
DERBY Station Inn, Midland Road: **ONE TIME SYNCOPATED CODPIECE**
HAVANT Black Dog: **ALAN WHITE**
LONDON HAMMERSMITH Prince of Wales, Dalling Road: **COLIN SCOTT**
LONDON REGENT PARK Bedford College: **DIZ DISLEY / CHRIS FOSTER**
LONDON SOHO Shakespeares Head, Carnaby Street: **DECAMERON**
NOTTINGHAM Windsor Castle, Carlton Hill: **SAGA**
POYNTON Folk Centre, Park Lane: **FOKAL POYNT**

RADIO 1

7 a.m. Tony Blackburn; 9.0 Jimmy Young with Gilbert O'Sullivan/Four Tops/Blue Mink/Fortunes/Johnny Johnson & Bandwagon; 11.0 Dave Lee Travis with Drifters-/Jackie Wilson/Neil Sedaka/Christie; 1 p.m. Johnnie Walker with Rod Stewart and Friends/Peter Frampton's Camel/Dandy Livingstone/Raymond Froggatt; 3.0 Alan Freeman with Middle Of The Road/Jim Croce/Jackie Wilson/Searchers; 5.0-7.0 "Radio 1 Club" with Ed Stewart; 10.0-12 midnight John Peel introduces "Sounds Of The Seventies" with Jethro Tull/Honeybus/Clifford T. Ward.

LUXEMBOURG

7.45 p.m. Tony Prince; 9.30 Paul Burnett; 11.0 Dave Christian; 12 midnight Bob Stewart; 1 a.m.-3.0 Kid Jensen.

TELEVISION

"Top Of The Pops" with Jimmy Savile (BBC-1); "The Dave Cash Radio Programme" with Pentangle/Mungo Jerry/Ashton Gardner Dyke & Co/Edison Lighthouse (most ITV regions, including London and Midlands); "Monty Python's Flying Circus" (BBC-1).

FRIDAY

ABERDEEN University: **RAYMOND FROGGATT**
ABERYSTWYTH University: **MUNGO JERRY**
● Once there used to be a fine, good-time jug band going under the name of Mungo Jerry. Alas, it no longer exists. Behold, the Ray Dorset Electric Ego has taken its place.
BATH Polytechnic: **SNAKE EYE**
BATH University: **GOOD HABIT**
BIRMINGHAM Aston University: **HEADS HANDS AND FEET**
BLACKPOOL Winter Gardens Planet Room: **NEW WORLD**
BOLTON Institute of Technology: **JOHN MARTIN-/SPIROGYRA/HOLY ROLLER**
● Charity Concert
BOURNEMOUTH Winter Gardens: **"UP COUNTRY" PACKAGE TOUR**
BRIGHTON Dome: **TOM PAXTON**
BRIGHTON The Richmond: **IMPALAS**
BRIGHTON Top Rank: **LINDISFARNE/GENESIS/RAB NOAKES**
BRISTOL Top Rank: **JIMMY CLIFF**
BURTON-ON-TRENT 76 Club: **UNICORN**
CARDIFF Capitol: **FOUR TOPS**
CHADWELL HEATH Hinds Head: **ARTHUR BROWN**
CHETENHAM Pavilion: **HOME**
● Those who went to see Mott at the Rainbow the other week came back talking about Home, instead. A good one to check out, we say.
CLEATOR MOOR W.M.C.: **WILD WALLY**
CUMNOCK Town Hall: **SHAKIN' STEVENS**
DARLINGTON Baths Hall: **CHICORY TIP**
DONCASTER Side Saddle Country Club: **VANITY FARE**
DRIFFIELD White Horse Inn: **RONNIE HILTON**
DUBLIN Trinity College: **AL STEWART**
● See Thursday
DUNDEE University: **JACKSON HEIGHTS**
EGHAM Royal Holloway College: **FLASH**
EXETER University: **STRAWBS**
FALKIRK Maniqui: **FAGIN**
GLASGOW Clouds: **SALVATION**
GLASGOW Strathclyde University: **STEELEYE SPAN/ AMAZIN' BLONDEL**
GLASGLOW White Elephant: **CINNAMON**
HATFIELD Polytechnic: **CURVED AIR/ZOE**
HERTFORD Flamingo Ballroom: **WORTH**
HIGH WYCOMBE Nag's Head: **ROCKIN' DEVILS**
LANCHESTER Polytechnic: **JEAN-LUC PONTY/BOND & BROWN/ELLIS**
LEEDS Polytechnic: **LOU REED/PHILLIP GOODHAND-TAIT**
LONDON BRIXTON Sundown: **MANFRED MANN's EARTH BAND/SAMMY**
LONDON Cafe des Artistes: **JUDAS PRIEST**
LONDON CHARING CROSS Sundown: **STYLISTICS**
LONDON CHISWICK Polytechnic: **JONATHAN KELLY**
● See Thursday
LONDON College of Printing: **MOTT THE HOOPLE**
LONDON HAMMERSMITH Odeon: **"NEWPORT JAZZ FESTIVAL IN LONDON"** with **DAVE BRUBECK TRIO/PAUL DESMOND/GERRY MULLIGAN**
LONDON ISLINGTON Town Hall: **CMU/GLOBAL VILLAGE TRUCKING COMPANY**
LONDON LEYTONSTONE Red Lion: **COLIN BLUNSTONE BAND**
LONDON Marquee: **CHAMPION JACK DUPREE**
LONDON Rainbow: **RALPH McTELL/NATURAL ACOUSTIC BAND**
● Quite a sophisticated songwirter really is Ralph, although his new album is a bit disappointing. However, this is his first-ever Rainbow gig so he's got an enthusiastic following.
LONDON Upstairs at Ronnie's: **OVARY LODGE**
MAIDENHEAD Youth Centre: **FLESH**
MANCHESTER Free Trade Hall: **SOFT MACHINE**
MANCHESTER Odeon: **CLIFF RICHARD**
MANCHESTER Village Disco: **GARY GLITTER**
MERTON Civic Centre: **PINK FAIRIES**
NEWCASTLE University: **PRETTY THINGS**
NEWPORT (Salop) Hooper Adam Ag. College: **DR. MARIGOLD'S**
NOTTINGHAM University: **FOCUS**
● See Thursday
PLYMOUTH Tiffany's: **MONTANAS**
READING University: **BREWERS DROOP/HOOKFOOT**
● Want to see a band more in it for the fun than the money? Then drop in on Droop, thrill to Ron's knees and booze and boogie the night away. Rude and vibrant.
SALFORD Technical College: **BRINSLEY SCWARZ**
SANQUHAR Town Hall: **VEHICLE/HOLOCAUST**
SOUTHAMPTON College of Education: **ROCK AND ROLL ALLSTARS**
SOUTHAMPTON University: **DICK HECKSTALL-SMITH BAND**
SOUTHEND Palace Bars: **CRAZY CAVAN**
SOUTHPORT Floral Hall: **BUDDY RICH ORCHESTRA**
SOUTH SHIELDS South Tyne Folk-Blues Club: **EDDIE 'GUITAR' BURNS**
ST. ALBANS City Hall: **PENTANGLE/C.O.B./WIZZ JONES**
STAFFORD Polytechnic: **CLIMAX CHICAGO**
STOCKTON ABC: **SPINNERS**
STOKE Alsager College: **E.L.O.**
STOURBRIDGE Envil Sports Club: **DAVE CARTWRIGHT**
SUNDERLAND Locarno: **GLENCOE**
SUNDERLAND Top Rank: **BEGGARS OPERA**
SWINDON Vickers Armstrong Social Club: **SYD LAWRENCE ORCHESTRA**
WALTHAM FOREST Technical College: **HUMBLE PIE**
● Deep in Humble Pie land (three of the band live nearby) the band open their long-awaited British tour. A great, great rock band with 100 per cent energy and guts guaranteed. Bands like Pie keep it all alive.
WATFORD New Penny Disco: **JUMBO**
WESTCLIFF-ON-SEA Queens Pavilion: **ARGENT**
UXBRIDGE Brunel University: **ALBION COUNTRY BAND**
WINDSOR University: **HOOKFOOT**
YORK University: **B. B. KING**

— FRIDAY FOLK —

BINGHAM Wheatsheaf: **RIPLEY WAYFARERS**
BODMIN Garland Ox: **COMEALLYE**
BOURNEMOUTH Penbroke Arms, Westhill Road: **DEREK & DOROTHY ELLIOTT**
BRIGHTON Springfield Hote, Springfield Rd.: **TERRY MASTERSON**
BURTON-ON-TRENT Barley Mow, Main Street, Stapenhill: **BARRY SKINNER**
CASTLE DONNINGTON Three Horseshoes, Hemington: **SWAN ARCADE**
FARNHAM William Cobbett, Abbey Street: **JIMMY MURRAY**
GOONHAVERN New Folk Cottage: **MIKE BOREHAM**
GRAVESEND Leo Lodge, Windmill Hill: **BULLY WEE**
KINGSWINFORD Woodman, Mount Pleasant: **PURITANS**
LONDON FULHAM Golden Lion, High Street: **BRIAN GRAYSON**
LONDON HENDON Oval: **WALLY WHYTON**
LONDON PUTNEY Half Moon, Lower Richmond Road: **DECAMERON**
MANCHESTER Duke of York, Eccles: **SARABAND**
NOTTINGHAM Playhouse: **BOB PEGG & NICK STRUTT**
PONTARDAWE Ivy Bush, High Street: **JOHN FOREMAN**
PORTSMOUTH Star Inn, Lake Road: **JOHN ST FIELD /HELEN WOODALLL**
STOCKTON-UPON-TEES ABC Cinema: **SPINNERS**
TORQUAY Country House Hotel, Ellacombe Road: **STEVE HEAP / BOB STEWART**

RADIO 1

7 a.m.-5 p.m. As Thursday; 5.0-7.0 "Rosko's Round Table"; 10.0-12 midnight "Sounds Of The Seventies" featuring Pete Drummond with "Sequence" in stereo.

LUXEMBOUTG

7.45 p.m. Tony Prince; 9.30 Mark Wesley; 10.30 Dave Christian; 11.30 Bob Stewart; 1 a.m.-3.0 Rosco

TELEVISION

George and Ira Gershwin's musical "Of Thee I Sing" (BBC-1); "Melody Inn" (ITV lunchtime).

SATURDAY

ABINGDON Radley College: **SKIN ALLEY**
BIRMINGHAM Town Hall: **TEN YEARS AFTER**
● Their first tour for a year and it's good to see them back on the road. They're not everybody's favourite band, but still one of the best for fast — and loud — rock and roll. And if you listen carefully, you may even **hear** Chick Churchill.
BOURNEMOUTH Winter Gardens: **FOUR TOPS / THELMA HOUSTON**
BRADFORD University: **FOCUS**
● see Thursday.
BRISTOL Polytechnic: **ELO**
BRISTOL Polytechnic: **EDDIE "GUITAR" BURNS**
BRISTOL University: **DICK HECKSTALL-SMITH BAND**
CAMBRIDGE Corn Exchange: **ARGENT/SNAKE EYE**
CANNOCK Snoopy's: **CHICORY TIP**
CHATHAM Central Hall: **BUDDY RICH ORCHESTRA**
CHESTER College: **WARHORSE**
COLERAINE New University: **AL STEWART**
● see Thursday.
DAGENHAM Hind's Head: **CRAZY CAVAN**
DAGENHAN Village Roundhouse: **STRAY**
DRIFFIELD White Horse Inn: **RONNIE HILTON**
DUNDEE JM: **CINNAMON**
DUNDEE Caird Hall: **STEELEYE SPAN / AMAZING BLONDEL**
EDINBURGH Empire: **SOFT MACHINE**
EGHAM Shoreditch College: **MIKE ABSALOM/SAM APPLE PIE**
EXETER Tiffany's: **MONTANAS**
FALKIRK Moniqui: **SWEATBAND**
FELIXSTOWE Palace Pier: **IMPALAS**
FOLKESTONE Leas Cliff Hotel: **CURVED AIR**
● see Thursday.
GLASGOW Clouds: **BUBBLES**
GLASGOW QM: **RAYMOND FROGGATT/SHAKIN' STEVENS**
GLASGOW University: **SANDY DENNY/GREENMANTLE/TOM FERRIE**
● Sandy's solo efforts were a bit shaky to start with, but things are straightened out now. Recent reviews have been enthusiastic without being ecstatic. But she's a fine, and genuine, talent — and she believes in her songs.
GLASGOW University (Q. Margaret U.): **SHAKIN' STEVENS**
GORLESTON Floral Hall: **SYD LAWRENCE ORCHESTRA**
HULL City Hall: **SPINNERS**
HULL University (Lawns Centre): **GENESIS**
KETTERING Granada: **"UP COUNTRY" PACKAGE TOUR**
KINGSTON Polytechnic: **LOU REED**
KINGSTON Polytechnic: **SCREAMIN' LORD SUTCH-/ROCK REBELLION**
KINGSTON Polytechnic: **LOU REED / PHILIP GOODHAND-TAIT**
LEEDS University: **HOME**
● see Friday
LLANELLI Glen Ballroom: **CARAVAN**
LONDON BRIXTON Sundown: **B.B. KING**
LONDON CHELSEA Pheasantry: **JUDAS PRIEST**
LONDON City University: **THANK YOU**
LONDON HAMMERSMITH Odeon: **"NEWPORT JAZZ FESTIVAL"** with **DIZZY GILLESPIE/THELONIUS MONK/SONNY STITT/ART BLAKEY/KAI WINDING/AL McKIBBA.**
LONDON Imperial College: **ROY YOUNG BAND**
LONDON Royal Festival Hall: **PENTANGLE/COB/WIZZ JONES.**
● The ever genteel Pentangle, banjoist Clive Palmer's COB and all-time veteran of St. Ives, Brighton beach and other scenes — Wizz Jones.
LONDON WEMBLEY Empire Pool: **SLADE/BLACKFOOT SUE**
● SOS Charity Concert — see also Sunday.
LONDON WOOD GREEN Fishmonger'S Arms: **MEMPHIS BEND**
LUTON College: **HOOKFOOT/QUIVER**
MANCHESTER Village Disco: **EQUALS**
MARGATE Dreamland: **GARY GLITTER**
MILLOM (Cumberland) Cambrian Club: **WILD WALLY**
MORLEY RAF Swanton: **DR. MARIGOLD'S**
NORTHAMPTON Cricket Ground: **NECRO-MANDUS**
NORTHAMPTON Polytechnic: **HEADS HANDS AND FEET**
NOTTINGHAM Intercom: **TAMI LYNN**
READING Bulmershe College: **RARE BIRD**
● admission 20p.
RETFORD Eaton Hall: **HOLY MACKEREL**
SHEFFIELD City Hall: **CLIFF RICHARD**
SHEFFIELD University: **JONATHAN KELLY**
● see Thursday
SOUTHEND Palace Bars: **ROCKIN' DEVILS**
STAINES Town Hall: **BREWERS DROOP**
● see Friday
SUTTON COLDFIELD Belfry: **SUZI QUATRO BAND/ R—1ELLIS D/ELLIS**
TUNSTALL Golden Torch: **STYLISTICS**
TWICKENHAM Technical College: **GOOD HABIT**
WESTGATE-ON-SEA Millies' Disco: **WORTH**
WESTON-SUPER-MARE Winter Gardens: **ROXY MUSIC**
WINCHESTER Castle Club: **ROCK CIRCUS**

FOLK

BARNSLEY Civic Hall: **DEREK & DOROTHY ELLIOTT**
BATH University: **CEILIDH** with **MARTIN CARTHY/ HILL BUTTON BAND**
BELPER Old Kings Head: **JACKO MURPHY**
BOGNOR REGIS Ashley House, Aldwick Road: **VERA JOHNSON**
BOLSOVER Blue Bell, High Street: **MAUN VALLEY RAMBLERS**
CROPWELL BISHOP Wheatsheaf: **JOHNNY HANDLE**
HULL Town Hall: **SPINNERS**
LEWES Lewes Arms, Mount Pleasant: **BILL CLIFTON**
LEYTON Senior High School for Boys: **GASWORKS-/JENNY BEECHING/WINDFALL/JUNE TABOR-/ANDY FERNBACH & TIM GREENWOOD**
LONDON CHALK FARM The Howff, 109a Regents Park Road: **YETTIES**
LONDON EARLS COURT Troubadour, Old Brompton Road: **WESTON GAVIN**
MALMESBURY St. Mary's Hall: **DANCE** with **STAN WEITZEL**
PENZANCE Western Hotel: **MIKE BOREHAM**
RIPLEY Church Hall, Moseley Street: **JACQUIE & BRIDIE/JACK HUDSON/WAYFARERS**
SHEFFIELD Highcliffe Hotel, Greystones Road: **NOEL MURPHY & MIKE WHELLANS**
STEVENAGE Red Lion, High Street: **STEFAN & LIZ SOBELL**
WEST PENNARD Village Hall: **DANCE** with **JOHN CHAPMAN/FIRKINS**

RADIO 1

8 a.m. "Junior Choice" with Ed Stewart; 9.55 Stuart Henry; 12 noon Rosko; 2 p.m. Bob Baker; 4.0 "Scene And Heard" with Johnny Moran; 5.0 David Simmons; 6.30-7.30 Alan Black introduces "In Concert" with Stone The Crows.

LUXEMBOURG

7.45 p.m. Tony Prince; 9.30 Mark Wesley; 11.0 Dave Christian; 12 midnight Paul Burnett; 1 a.m.-3.0 Kid Jensen.

TELEVISION

Gilbert O'Sullivan/Vikki Carr in "The Rolf Harris Show" (ITV); Gladys Knight and the Pips in "Full House" (BBC-2); Robert Goulet in "The Julie Andrews Hour" (ITV); The Osmonds cartoon series (some ITV regions, including London and Midlands); "The Partridge Family" with David Cassidy and Shirley Jones (London ITV); Georgie Fame & Alan Price/Samantha Jones in "The Two Ronnies" (BBC-1); The Goons/Ray Ellington Quartet in "Parkinson" (BBC-1).

SUNDAY

ACCRINGTON Lake Land Lounge: **HOLY ROLLER**
AIRDRIE Countdown: **VERGE**

MOVIE GL

ABERDEEN Odeon: **CREAM / DON'T LOOK BACK / JOAN / MONTEREY POP / SOUNDS OF THE SEVENTIES**
● Saturday only (all-night).
BATH ABC: **FRITZ THE CAT**
● Thursday for three days.
BECKENHAM ABC: **FRITZ THE CAT**
● Thursday for three days.
BOLTON Film Theatre: **MONTEREY POP / CREAM**
BRIGHTON Film Theatre: **GRAVE NEW WORLD/ PLOD / PICTURES AT AN EXHIBITION**
● Thursday for three days.
BURTON Odeon: **A HARD DAY'S NIGHT**
● Friday only.
CAMBRIDGE ABC: **FRITZ THE CAT**
● Thursday for three days.
CANTERBURY Odeon: **MONTEREY POP/FESTIVAL**
● Friday only.
CHIPPENHAM Studio One: **FRITZ THE CAT / ALICE'S RESTAURANT**
● Sunday for seven days.
CHORLEY Studio One: **FRITZ THE CAT**
● Thursday for three days.
COLWYN BAY Wedgewood: **MAD DOGS AND ENGLISHMEN**
● Wednesday only.
CROYDON Fairfield Hall: **WOODSTOCK**
● Monday only.
CWMBRAN Studio: **ELVIS — THAT'S THE WAY IT IS**
● Thursday for three days.
DUMFRIES ABC: **FRITZ THE CAT**
● Thursday for three days.
FDINBURGH Tivoli: **ELVIS — THAT'S THE WAY IT IS**
● Thursday for three days.
FARNHAM Studio One: **DON'T LOOK BACK/ /JOAN**
● Saturday only.
FOLKESTONE Odeon: **WOODSTOCK**
● Thursday only.
GODALMING Classic: **WOODSTOCK**
● Sunday only.
HALTWHISTLE Cinema: **ELVIS — THAT'S THE WAY IT IS**
● Wednesday for two days.
HARTLEPOOL Odeon: **CREAM / FESTIVAL / MONTEREY POP / SOUNDS OF THE SEVENTIES**
● Sunday only (all-night?).
HAYES Classic: **DON'T LOOK BACK/JOAN**
● Saturday only.
LANCASTER ABC: **FRITZ THE CAT**
● Sunday for seven days.
LERWICK North Star: **ELVIS — THAT'S THE WAY IT IS**
● Saturday for two days.

WIDE GIG GUIDE

● While every effort is made to ensure the accuracy of the dates in the Gig Guide we don't claim infallibility. Gigs may be subject to late change and we suggest you check locally whenever possible. Remember also to check for further information with the advertising in this supplement.



THEIR FIRST British gig may prove a strange experience for the JACKSON 5, when they face the monkey-suited audience at the LONDON Palladium on Monday in the Royal Variety Show, in the presence of the Queen Mother. Also featured: Elton John and Jack Jones. Catch the show on BBC-1 the following Sunday (5).

ALCESTER Cherry Tree Motel: **DAVE CARTWRIGHT**
BATLEY Variety Club: **GLADYS KNIGHT AND THE PIPS**
BELFAST Queens University: **AL STEWART**
● see Thursday
BEXLEY Black Prince: **CLIMAX CHICAGO / COLIN BLUNSTONE BAND**
BIRMINGHAM Enry's Blueshouse: **SHAMELADY**
BIRMINGHAM Hideaway: **ROCKIN' DEVILS**
BLETCHLEY Youth Centre: **CHAMPION JACK DUPREE**
BOTLEY Dolphin Hotel: **YAKETTY YAK**
BRIDGEND Crossways Country Club: **GOOD HABIT**
BRISTOL Locarno: **STRAWBS / DUNCAN BROWNE**
CANTERBURY University (Keynes College): **MIKE ABSALOM**
CARLISLE Cosmo Club: **WILD WALLY**
CROYDON Greyhound: **STRAY**
DORCHESTER Tavern Club: **MONTANNAS**
GLASGOW Clouds: **SHAKIN' STEVENS**
GRAVESEND Civic Hall: **FLASH**
HULL Arts Centre: **CLAIRE HAMILL**
● The diminutive Claire back on the scene after something of an absence. She's bright 'n' chirpy, though, and — like an uncouth brandy — will mature with age.
KINGSTON Swan: **IMPALAS**
KIRKCALDY Templehall: **CRISP**
LEEDS Town Hall: **SPINNERS**
LEICESTER De Montfort Hall: **TOM PAXTON**
LIVERPOOL Empire: **FOUR TOPS / THELMA HOUSTON**
LLANELLI Festival: **RARE BIRD**
● Admission 20p
LONDON Coliseum: **HUMBLE PIE**
● See Friday
LONDON CHALK FARM Roundhouse: **ELLIS**
LONDON FINCHLEY Torrington: **HELP YOURSELF**
LONDON ILFORD Growling Budgie: **JUDAS PRIEST**
LONDON LEWISHAM Odeon: **LINDISFARNE /GENESIS / RAB NOAKES**
LONDON New Victoria: **BUDDY RICH ORCHESTRA**
LONDON Upstairs at Ronnies: **NIGER**
LONDON WEMBLEY Empire Pool: **FACES / PINK FAIRIES**
● A Daily Express (of all things) promoted concert — but all in aid of a good cause — The Stars Organisation for Spastics. So long as they go easy on the boozing before they go on, Rod and the boys should put on a good show. Plus the Pink Finks.
NEWCASTLE City Hall: **TEN YEARS AFTER**
● See Saturday
OXFORD New Theatre: **PENTANGLE**
REDHILL Greyhound: **SOLID GOLD CADILLAC**
SHEFFIELD University: **JOHN JAMES**
SOUTHALL Greenford Hotel: **CRAZY CAVAN**
SOUTHAMPTON Concorde: **HOUSESHAKERS**
SOUTHAMPTON Gaumont: **"UP COUNTRY" PACKAGE TOUR**
SOUTHAMPTON Guildhall: **PHILLIP GOODHAND-TAIT**
SOUTHAMPTON University: **LOU REED**
SOUTHEND Cliffs Pavilion: **SYD LAWRENCE ORCHESTRA**
SOUTHEND Queen's Hotel: **PINK FAIRIES**
SUNDERLAND Empire: **DANA / VINCE HILL**
SWANSEA Pandora's: **FOCUS**
● See Thursday
SWINDON Wyvern: **RALPH McTELL/NATURAL ACOUSTIC BAND**
● See Friday
UXBRIDGE Brunel University: **BREWER'S DROOP**
● See Friday
WATFORD Top Rank: **STYLISTICS**
WESTCLIFF Queen's Hotel: **HOME**
● See Friday

FOLK

BARNSLEY Civic Hall: **PENTANGLE/COB**
BENFLEET Anchor: **SARABAND**
BOURNEMOUTH Pembroke Arms, Westhill Road: **JOHN ST. FIELD/ALEX ATTERSON**
BRIGHTON Stanford Arms, Preston Circus: **RON SIMMONDS**
DAVENTRY Dun Cow, Brook Street: **JOE STEAD**
GREENFIELD Pennine Apres Ski Lodge, Shaw Hall Bank Road: **BLUEWATER FOLK**
HORSHAM Anchor, East Street: **DAVE BURLAND**
HYTHE (Hants) Westcliff Hall Hotel: **YARDARM**
LEEDS Town Hall: **SPINNERS**
LINCOLN Aquarius Club, High Street: **REDD SULLIVAN**
LONDON BOUNDS GREEN Springfield Park Tavern: **MARTIN WYNDHAM-READ**
LONDON FORREST HILL Bird in Hand: **SOUTHERN RAMBLERS**
LONDON WEST END Crypt of St. Martin-in-the-Fields: **PEELERS/JENNY BEECHING**
LOUGHBOROUGH White Horse Inn, Quorn: **ISLA ST. CLAIR**
MALVERN Nags Head, Bank Street: **VERA JOHNSON**
MANCHESTER Golden Lion, Wilmslow Road, Withington: **McCALMANS**
NEWBURY Wagon & Horses: **STAN ARNOLD**
PLYMOUTH Continental Hotel, Millbay Road: **MARTIN CARTHY**
POYNTON Folk Centre, Park Lane: **WALLY WHYTON**
ST. ALBANS Goat Inn, Sopwell Lane: **CEILIDH**
SWINDON Wyvern Theatre: **RALPH McTELL**
WARRINGTON White Hart, Sankey Street: **DEREK & DOROTHY ELLIOTT**
RADIO ONE: 7 p.m. **SOUNDS ON SUNDAY** with **PENTANGLE**

RADIO 1

8 a.m. Barry Alldis; 9.0 "Junior Choice" with Ed Stewart; 10.0 Noel Edmonds; 12 noon "Family Favourites"; 2 p.m. Jimmy Savile with "Savile's Travels" followed by "Speak-Easy"; 4.0 "Solid Gold Sixty" with Tom Browne; 7.0-7.30 "Sounds On Sunday" with Pentangle.

LUXEMBOURG

6.15 Tony Prince; 8.0 Paul Burnett; 9.30 Mark Wesley; 10.30 Dave Christian; 12 midnight Bob Stewart; 1 a.m.-2.30 Kid Jensen.
**From tonight, Luxembourg programmes start one hour earlier and finish half-an-hour earlier.

TELEVISION

U.S. country singer Sammy Smith in "The Golden Shot" (ITV); Mantovani and his Orchestra with Tommy Leonetti (BBC-2); Hollywood movie "Some Like It Hot" with Marilyn Monroe/Jack Lemmon/Tony Curtis (BBC-2).

MONDAY

BIRMINGHAM Town Hall: **TOM PAXTON**
COLCHESTER Wood St. Sports Centre: **SWEET**
DUNSTABLE Civic Hall: **LOU REED**
DUNSTABLE Civic Hall: **PHILIP GOODHAND-TAIT**
EDINBURGH Carey Theatre: **TEN YEARS AFTER**
● see Saturday
GLASGOW Clydebank Bankies Club: **BILLY FURY**
GUILDFORD Civic Hall: **FOCUS**
● see Thursday
LEICESTER Croft Club: **GOOD HABIT**
LEICESTER De Montfort Hall: **SOFT MACHINE**
CHESTER Quaintways: **BEGGARS OPERA/NECROMANDUS**
LONDON ILFORD Growling Budgie: **JUDAS PRIEST**
LONDON Marquee: **COLIN BLUNSTONE BAND**
LONDON Palladium: **JACKSON 5/ELTON JOHN/JACK JONES**
● Quite a progressive bill for the Royal Variety Show really, which has long ignored rock. But who cares? If asked, would the Stones/Faces/ELP do it anyway? And if they did, what would the Telegraph say?
LONDON Upstairs at Ronnie's: **NIGER**
NEWCASTLE City Hall: **PENTANGLE/COB/WIZZ JONES**
● see Saturday
READING Town Hall: **ROXY MUSIC**
● see Saturday
STAFFORD Top of the World: **TAMI LYNN**
STANFORD-LE-HOPE Kings Head: **CLEAR BLUE SKY**
SWANSEA College: **RARE BIRD**
● free gig
SWANSEA Patti Pavilion: **HOME**
● see Friday
TAUNTON Camelot: **JOHNNIE WALKER MOTOWN DISCO**
WOLVERHAMPTON Lafayette: **MONTANAS**

FOLK

AMBERLEY Black Horse: **BRYAN CHALKER'S NEW FRONTIER**
ARNOLD Cross Keys, Front St.: **COMEALLYE**
CRANWELL RAF: **EVERYDAY DIRT**
LEEDS Town Hall: **PENTANGLE/COB**
SHACKLEFORD Social Centre: **WILD OATS**
SHIRLEY Blacksmiths Arms: **JOHN ST FIELD/ALEX ATTERSON**

RADIO 1

7 a.m. Tony Blackburn; 9.0 Jimmy Young with Labi Siffre, Neil Sedaka, Junior Campbell, Anne Murray, Brotherhood Of Man; 11.0 Dave Lee Travis with Blue Mink, Cat Stevens, Chairmen Of The Board, Gene Pitney; 1 p.m. Johnnie Walker with David Bowie, Gilbert O'Sullivan, Mickey Newbury, Lesley Duncan, Magna Carta; 3.0 Alan Freeman with Cat Stevens, Medicine Head, Jim Croce, Desmond Dekker; 5.0-7.0 "Radio 1 Club" with Rosko; 10.0-12 midnight Bob Harris introduces "Sounds Of The Seventies" with Peter Frampton, Pretty Things, Sutherland Brothers, Tucker Zimmerman.

LUXEMBOURG

6.45 p.m. Mark Wesley; 8.30 Paul Burnett; 10.0 Dave Christian; 11.30 Bob Stewart; 1 a.m.-2.30 Kid Jensen.

TELEVISION

Labi Siffre, Mirielle Mathieu, Dawn, Sacha Distel in "Sacha's In Town" (BBC-2); "Sez Les" (ITV).

TUESDAY

BIRMINGHAM Bogarts: **ORPHAN**
BIRMINGHAM 'Enry's Blueshouse: **CHICKEN SHACK**
● Long-standing and oft-ignored Stan Webb is still stepping out with de blooze. Who knows about Chicken Shack these days but Mr. Webb himself is always worth the price of admission. Ace guitarist-tippler. Fun, fun, fun.
BRIGHTON Top Rank (Doubling **LONDON** Gulliver 1): **SCREAMIN' LORD SUTCH/ROCK REBELLION**
CANTERBURY Kent University: **BREWERS DROOP**
● See Friday
CHATHAM Town Hall: **ROXY MUSIC**
● See Saturday
DUBLIN Stadium: **GILBERT O'SULLIVAN**
EASTBOURNE Congress: **BUDDY RICH ORCHESTRA**
EDINBURGH Clouds: **BEGGARS OPERA**
GLASGOW Kelvin Hall: **"UP COUNTRY" PACKAGE TOUR**
IPSWICH Baths: **FOCUS**.
● See Thursday
LANCASTER University: **RAVI SHANKAR**
● Simply — one of the world's greatest artists. You know what he does. What more can one say? If you like the tuning-up, you'll dig the music
LONDON HENDON Technical Coll.: **MINE ABSALOM**
LONDON Nightingale: **JUDAS PRIEST**
LONDON WOOD GREEN Nightingale: **HOME**
● See Friday
MAIDSTONE Corn Exchange: **PINK FAIRIES**
MANCHESTER Free Trade Hall: **HUMBLE PIE**
● See Friday
NORTHAMPTON Fantasia: **SPREADEAGLE**
SCUNTHORPE Civic Hall: **SOLID GOLD CADILLAC**
SHEFFIELD City Hall: **TOM PAXTON**
SOUTHEND Talk Of The South: **NEW WORLD**
STOKE Tiffany's: **TAMI LYNN**

FOLK

BEDWORTH Woolpack Inn: **HARVESTERS**
BRIGHTON Arlington, Marine Parade: **TAVERNERS**
CHADWELL HEATH Hinds Head, Burnside Road: **F.F.Z.**
CHORLEY Howard Arms, Whittle-le-Woods: **JACQUIE & BRIDIE**
CRAWLEY Locomotive, Three Bridges: **MOSAIC**
GILLINGHAM Ghuznee Fort, Saunders Road: **HOT POTATO**
PADSTOW Golden Lion: **ROGUES CORNER**
LONDON LEYTON William IV, High Road: **MARY ANN EDGAR & DAVE DYKE**
LONG CRENDON Churchill Arms, High Street: **SINGERS NIGHT**
RIPLEY Horse & Jockey, Cromford Road: **EVERYDAY DIRT**
WADDINGTON Horse & Jockey: **MARIE LITTLE**

RADIO 1

7 a.m.-5 p.m. As Monday; 5.0-7.0 "Radio 1 Club" with Noel Edmonds; 10.0-12 midnight John Peel's "Top Gear" with Supertramp/JSD Band/Barry Dransfield.

LUXEMBOURG

6.45 p.m. Tony Prince; 8.30 Mark Wesley; 9.30 Paul Burnett; 11.0 Bob Stewart; 1 a.m.-2.30 Kid Jensen.

TELEVISION

Ellis/Harry Chapin in "The Old Grey Whistle Test" (BBC-2); The Jackson Five cartoon series (some ITV regions, including Midlands); Terry Wogan/Carl Wayne/Penny Lane in "Lunchtime with Wogan" (most ITV regions, including London and Midlands); The Spinners' Hallowe'en special (BBC-1).

WEDNESDAY

ABERDEEN University: **RARE BIRD**
● free gig
BIRMINGHAM Town Hall: **PENTANGLE / COB / WIZZ JONES**
COLCHESTER Wood Street Sports Centre: **SWEET**
CROYDON Fairfield Hall: **BUDDY RICH ORCHESTRA**
EDINBURGH Odeon: **"UP COUNTRY" PACKAGE TOUR**
GLASGOW City Hall: **RALPH McTELL / NATURAL ACOUSTIC BAND**
● see Friday
GLASGOW Kelvin Hall: **RAVI SHANKAR**
● see Tuesday
GREENFORD Big Brother: **MICK ABRAHAMS BAND**
GUILDFORD Civic Hall: **SOFT MACHINE**
KEELE University: **PRETTY THINGS**
LEICESTER College of Education: **JONATHAN KELLY**
● see Thursday
LONDON GREENFORD Big Brother: **JUDAS PRIEST**
LONDON MILE END Sundown: **LOU REED / PHILLIP GOODHAND-TAIT**
LONDON Marquee: **MIKE D'ABO/SUNRISE**
LONDON NEW CROSS Goldsmith's College: **BREWERS DROOP**
● see Friday
MANCHESTER Polytechnic: **FOCUS**
● see Thursday
MANCHESTER Village Disco: **ROSKO ROAD SHOW**
NEWCASTLE City Hall: **CLIFF RICHARD**
NEWCASTLE Odeon: **HUMBLE PIE**
● see Friday
NORWICH East Anglia University: **BARCLAY JAMES HARVEST**
PLYMOUTH Polytechnic: **BUDGIE**
SOUTHEND Talk Of The South: **NEW WORLD**

FOLK

GRANTHAM Black Dog, Watergate: **BERNARD WRIGLEY**
LONDON TEDDINGTON Barmy Arms, Riverside: **SIMON PRAGER & STEVE RYE**
LONDON WEST END Adams Arms, Conway Street: **SARA GREY**
WARWICK Globe Hotel, Theatre Street: **VERA JOHNSON**
RADIO TWO (VHF ONLY, 200kH2) & **RADIO ONE:** 8.30 p.m. **FOLK ON TWO** with **BOYS OF THE LOUGH/JOHN & CHRISTINE**

RADIO 1

7 a.m.-5 p.m. As Monday; 5.0-7.0 "Radio 1 Club" with Stuart Henry; 10.0-12 midnight "Sounds Of The Seventies" with Anne Nightingale/Alan Black presenting "Review".

LUXEMBOURG

Details not yet to hand.

TELEVISION

Fortunes/Junior Campbell/Jack Wild in "Lift Off" (ITV); "The Dave Cash Radio Programme" (some ITV regions); Andy Stewart in "Scotch Corner" (most ITV regions, lunchtime).

RESIDENCIES

LEIGH Carrick: **TOMMY HUNT**
● Week from Sunday
LIVERPOOL Allison's (doubling Wookey Hollow): **DEL SHANNON**
● Week from Sunday
LLANELLI Glen Ballroom: **EMILE FORD**
● 4-day residency starts Wednesday
LONDON CHARING X Global Village: **ANNIE ROSS**
● Every Thursday, Friday and Saturday
LONDON Palladium: **JACK JONES**
● Week from Sunday
MANCHESTER Broadway: **JACKIE TRENT/TONY HATCH**
● Week from Sunday
PRESTON Piper: **HURRICANE SMITH**
● Week from Sunday
SHEFFIELD Fiesta: **GEORGIE FAME & ALAN PRICE**
● Week from Sunday
SOLIHULL New Cresta Club: **SETTLERS**
● Week from Sunday
SWANSEA Gorseinon Melody Club: **MATT MONRO**
● Week from Sunday
WESTON-SUPER-MARE Webbington Country Club: **ROCKIN' BERRIES**
● Week from Tuesday
LONDON ALEXANDRA PALACE (Thursday to Saturday): **BRITISH BEER FESTIVAL**
Not strictly a folk custom . . . or is it? Lashings of ale (the keg stuff, we fear), commemorative glass tankard, singsongs, pearly kings and queens, **ACKER BILK / METROPOLITAN POLICE BAND / DRAGONS PLAYGROUND / CURTIS SINGERS / HAMMERSMITH MORRIS MEN / EARLS OF ESSEX MORRIS MEN**
ABERDEEN (Friday, Saturday, Sunday)
Town and University folk clubs combine to put on **BOYS OF THE LOUGH / BOB DAVENPORT / LIZ & STEFAN SOBEL / McCALMANS / PETE QUIN /ADAM MacNAUGHTON**

UPCOMING

AMON DUUL II
LONDON University College (November 17), **LOUGHBOROUGH** University (18), **ST. ANDREW'S** University (22), **GLASGOW** Art School (23), **STIRLING** University (24), **LONDON EDMONTON** Friars (25), **GUILDFORD** Civic Hall (27), **LONDON EDMONTON** Sundown (30), **LONDON ISLEWORTH** Polytechnic (December 1), **LONDON** Imperial College (2), **KEELE** University (6), **LIVERPOOL** Cavern (7), **BRISTOL** Polytechnic (8), **WATFORD** Technical College (9), **CROYDON** Greyhound (10), **LONDON MILE END** Sundown (13), **MARGATE** Dreamland (14), **EPSOM** Baths Hall (16).

DEL SHANNON
Alterations to his previously-reported schedule: gig at **BARROW** Club 99 on November 27 is cancelled; new date is **GOOLE** Viking and **DONCASTER** Side Saddle Country Club on November 30.

GLENCOE
TWICKENHAM St. Mary's College (Nov. 4), **GLASGOW** Strathclyde University (11), **CLEETHORPES** Winter Gardens (13), **LONDON FULHAM** Greyhound (16), **CREWE** South Cheshire College (17), **ABERDEEN** University (18), **STIRLING** University (19), **EXETER** St. Luke's College (24).

GROUNDHOGS
BIRMINGHAM Town Hall (November 17), **EDINBURGH** Empire (18), **DUNDEE** Caird Hall (19), **GLASGOW** Green's Playhouse (20), **NEWCASTLE** City Hall (26), **HANLEY** Victoria Hall (30), **MANCHESTER** Free Trade Hall (December 1), **BRISTOL** Colston Hall (3), **BRADFORD** St. George's Hall (5), **BARRY** Memorial Hall (6), **BOURNEMOUTH** Winter Gardens (8), **WOLVERHAMPTON** Town Hall (11), **SHEFFIELD** City Hall (15), **LIVERPOOL** Stadium (16), **LONDON** Rainbow (22). More to be announced next week.

JACKSON HEIGHTS
LOUGHBOROUGH University (November 8), **HALIFAX** Clarence's (11), **LONDON** Euston Road Shaw Theatre (12), **LONDON** Marquee (December 6), **BRIGHTON** College (8), **YORK** College (19).

ROSKO ROAD SHOW
WOLVERHAMPTON Lafayette (November 3), **LANCASTER** University (8), **DONCASTER** Baths Hall (9), **STAFFORD** Polytechnic (10), **SOUTHAMPTON** Top Rank (11), **BLACKPOOL** Norbrick Hydro (18), **BECKENHAM** Mistrale (24), **MANCHESTER** Village Disco (29).

STACKRIDGE/PIGSTY HILL LIGHT ORCHESTRA
LONDON College of St. Mark and St. John (December 1), **OXFORD** Polytechnic (2), **MANCHESTER** Stoneground (3), **SALISBURY** City Hall (5), **CARDIFF** University (6), **LEEDS** Polytechnic (7), **EGHAM** Royal Holloway College (8), **ST. ALBANS** City Hall (9).

UIDE

Compiled by JOHN PIDGEON

LIVERPOOL Tuebrook ABC: **FRITZ THE CAT**
● Sunday for seven days.
LIVERPOOL Walton ABC: **FRITZ THE CAT**
● Sunday for seven days.
LONDON Baker Street Times: **FRITZ THE CAT**
● Thursday for seven days.
LONDON Brixton Sundown: **GRAVE NEW WORLD-/PLOD/PICTURES AT AN EXHIBITION**
● Thursday only.
LONDON Brixton Sundown: **WOODSTOCK**
● Sunday for three days.
LONDON Brixton Sundown: **ALICE'S RESTAURANT**
● Wednesday only.
LONDON Clapham Imperial: **THE HARDER THEY COME**
● Sunday for seven days.
LONDON East Finchley Rex: **THE CONCERT FOR BANGLA DESH**
● Sunday for seven days.
LONDON Hampstead Classic: **MONTEREY POP-/CREAM**
● Friday for two days.
LONDON KILBURN State: **WOODSTOCK**
● Saturday for three days.
LONDON Panton Street Cinecenta: **FRITZ THE CAT**
● Thursday for seven days.
LONDON South Kensington Paris Pullman: **FRITZ THE CAT**
● Thursday for seven days.
LOWESTOFT Odeon: **WOODSTOCK**
● Saturday only.
MANCHESTER Studio 5: **FRITZ THE CAT**
● Thursday for three days.
MANCHESTER Gatley Tatton: **FRITZ THE CAT**
● Thursday for three days.
MANCHESTER Hale Cinemahouse: **FRITZ THE CAT**
● Thursday for three days.
MANCHESTER New Oxford: **WOODSTOCK**
● Friday only
MIDDLESBROUGH Majestic: **ELVIS — THAT'S WAY IT IS**
● Sunday for seven days.
MORECAMBE Empire: **FRITZ THE CAT**
● Sunday for seven days.
NEWCASTLE Film Theatre: **LET IT BE**
● Friday for two days.
PRESTON ABC: **FRITZ THE CAT**
● Thursday for three days
SHEFFIELD Vogue: **ELVIS — THAT'S THE WAY IT IS**
● Sunday for seven days.
SITTINGBOURNE Classic: **WOODSTOCK**
● Thursday for three days.
WALTON-ON-THAMES Odeon: **WOODSTOCK**
● Thursday for three days.
WALTON-ON-THAMES Odeon: **MAD DOGS AND ENGLISHMEN**
● Sunday only.
WOLVERHAMPTON Gaumont: **LET IT BE / YELLOW SUBMARINE**
● Friday for two days.

GIGLINES by JAMES JOHNSON, FOLKLINES by ERIC WINTER

ALBUM REVIEWS

Graham Parker's progress



GRAHAM PARKER AND THE RUMOUR
Squeezing Out Sparks. Vertigo 9102 030. Producer: Jack Nitsche. *Plenty of sparks in this one as Parker continues his relentless progress towards establishing himself as one of the most exciting yet accessible rock acts around. Has broadened his appeal with the help of Jack Nitsche and should sell in large quantities with tour and accompanying promotional support.*

TAVARES
Madam Butterfly. Capitol EA-ST 11874. Producer: Bobby Martin. A change of producer has not dented their appeal as recent UK concert appearances have proved. Their singles perhaps sell comparitively better than their albums, but this will still be a strong item, especially in the North. Best cut is the slow, mellow Never Had A Love Like This Before which shows the five brothers' voices at their best.
***

McGUINN, CLARK AND HILLMAN
McGuinn, Clark And Hillman. Capitol E-ST 11910. Producers: Ron Albert and Howard Albert. Three of the original Byrds back together — but not just to exploit their classic hits of the past. The superb vocal harmonies are still evident on cuts like Don't You Write Her Off and Surrender To Me, while interest was re-kindled by a recent UK visit.
***

MELANIE HARROLD
Blue Angel. DJM Records DJF 20550. Harrold was previously known as Joanna Carlin and now reverts to her own name, which is a shame — because she had built up a good reputation for herself under her old name and it's almost as though she has to start from scratch again. Suffice to say, however, this is yet another good album from the talented lady and deserves to establish her as one of the talents of the future. It includes her latest DJM single, I Live In The City, currently picking up airplay, the title track Blue Angel which was co-written with producer Hugh Murphy, and Stephen Bishop's Careless.
***

GRACE KENNEDY
Grace Kennedy. DJM Records DJF 20534. Grace Kennedy is a 21-year-old very talented singer, in the m-o-r vein, for whom big things are predicted. She recently made an appearance on the Bruce Forsyth Big Night TV show, which brought raves from the critics, and now she debuts on DJM with an album produced by Stephen James and Irving Martin. Peter Knight has done the musical arrangements, which gives some idea of the quality feeling surrounding this album, and the material is from a variety of sources including Lambert & Potter, Paul McCartney and David Martin. Kennedy begins a season at The Talk Of The Town in London later this month and with television exposure also lined up should enjoy reasonable success with this album.
***

DOLL BY DOLL
Remember. Automatic. K 56618. Producers, Bill Price and artists. Disappointing album that stands out because of its lack of originality. There is nothing here that hasn't been done before.
*

KIM FOWLEY
Sunset Boulevard. Illegal Records LP 002. Producers: Kim Fowley and Ralph Peer II. If Basil Fawlty ever turned his hand to making records, he might well come up with something like this. The only hitch is that whereas Fawlty's brand of humour has wide appeal, Fowley's is more of an acquired taste. Sunset Boulevard is Fowley's first all-new album for five years and its great for anyone who can tolerate kitsch overkill, but boring for the rest of us. Kim Fowley may have 50 gold records on his garage wall, but this is unlikely to provide him with his 51st.
*

WES MONTGOMERY
Solitude. Affinity AFF18. The second of two albums taped at a Paris concert in 1965 featuring the late Wes Montgomery. The first, Impressions, is available on Affinity AFF13. Masterly jazz guitar work with musicians including tenor sax player Johnny Griffin. Tracks: Mister Walker, To Django, Here's That Rainy Day, Round About Midnight.
***

JUDY COLLINS
Hard Times For Lovers. Elektra K52121. Her seventeenth album for the label and her first release since So Early In The Spring (July 1977). Wide variety of songs — including Desperado and I Remember Sky— which shows that she has considerably broadened her scope since the early folk days. Unfortunately, the album sleeve pic of the singer is not the most flattering.
**

SHIVANANDA
Headlines. Gnome Records. 6326 505. Producers: Kurt Weil and Dieter Bresse. Shivananda is a seven-piece Swiss band which has managed to steer clear of the Continental obsession with synthesizers to produce rhythmic, lightweight jazz rock, in much the same vein as Miroslav Viteous' Magical Shepherd. Pleasant listening.
**

VARIOUS ARTISTS
T For Texas. Charly CR 30162. Fine compilation of Texas country music. Artists include Charlie Walker, George Jones and Sleepy LaBeef who will be appearing at the Wembley Country Music Festival over Easter.
**

JOHNNY G
Sharp & Natural. Beggars Banquet BEGA 6. Talented songwriter and performer Johnny G has come up with a varied debut album for Beggars Banquet. Such a range of styles and moods is rare on one LP and this serves as a showcase for his talents. Includes his single, Golden Years.
**

JOHN COLTRANE
Coltranology Volume Two. Affinity. Aff 16. Recorded live at Stockholm's Koncerthusen in October, 1963 (as was volume one in 1961), the album highlights Trane's masterful control of the tenor sax and McCoy Tyner's fluid piano. Rythm section is Jimmy Garrison, bass, and Elvin Jones, recently returned to the band after a spell in Lexington Hospital, on drums. Recorded two years before Trane's death through cancer of the liver, the centre piece is Spiritual, a Coltrane composition based, as was much of his work, on a negro spiritual. Other tracks are Mr PC, Traneing In, I Want To Talk About You.
***



Jazz releases. . .

by PATRICK SULLIVAN

RONNIE FOSTER
Love Satellite. CBS 83037. Producer: Jerry Peters, Anonymous disco junk, oops sorry, funk from ex-George Benson sideman Foster. The prescence of Stevie Wonder on Happy Song does nothing to rescue anyone for the simple reason that on drums he sounds no better and no worse than Harvey Mason or Dennis Davis who play on the rest of the tracks. Boring and the very antithesis of jazz although it will probably do okay in the disco field.
**



GEORGE MELLY
Ain't Misbehavin'. Pye NSPL 18602. Producer: Terry Brown. With the Broadway hit show of the same name opening at Her Majesty's Theatre this month, the old sailor could have a very fast mover on his hands with this one. Fats Waller was, like Melly is, a larger than life character and his tunes get the sort of treatment they deserve here. I'm Gonna Sit Right Down and Write Myself a Letter, Your Feets Too Big and The Joint Is Jumpin, My Very Good Friend The Milkman and all the others are going to be clogging the airwaves pretty soon and this set is in on the ground floor.
***

STAN GETZ
Another World. CBS 88315. Produced by the Artist. A gorgeous album from the master saxophonist which shows him for the first time flirting with the benefits, or otherwise, that electronics can bestow. Lovers of the Getz purity of sound need have no fear as he plugs in on only one number, and even then manages to make it interesting. Excellent, newish band keeps Getz up on his toes and the programme is as personal as ever.
***

HUMPHREY LYTTLETON
Spreadin' Joy. Black Lion BLP 12173. Producer: The artist. Humph seems to have departed from his mainstream sources for this one with a few good old ones such as Tishomingo Blues, A Hundred Years From Today, East St Louis Toodle-oo and a couple of timely Waller tunes Black and Blue and Honeysuckle Rose. It all swings along nicely with excellent contributions from Roy Williams on trombone and Mike Pyne on piano.
**

ART FARMER/JIM HALL
Big Blues. CTI 7083. Producer: Creed Taylor. Farmer and Hall are two of the most tasteful and sensitive musicians on the scene, and this is one of the best releases from CTI in a long time. Hall's title track moves the feet, but I'm not too sure that drummer Steve Gadd is quite at home on this one. Good vibes from Mike Mainieri, a protégé of Buddy Rich, and likewise arrangements by David Matthews. Probably a little too low key to make a big impact, but useful to have around for discerning customers.
**

GYPSIES' BROOD

DOLL BY DOLL: 'Gypsy Blood' (Automatic K 56755)

TWO THINGS HAPPENED THIS WEEK. Draghet' and 'Gypsy Blood'. It's really as simple as that.

The Fall and Doll By Doll are taking to task the things that matter; they are both fighting. While The Fall attack the society and industry they work and live within, Doll By Doll's battle has been less clear.

The state rock and roll — as a communications medium — has degenerated into, really requires a kind of realistic emotional input, just as it needed it a decade ago. While armies of pathetic slobbering pseudo-romantics sell their gratuitous fake "love" songs in the name of rock and roll, the whole scene is slipping into a soya bean rebellion, where all statements and expressions are muffled, sanitised, State Approved, and like that.

Doll By Doll have *fibre*. Their first album — 'Remember' — was harangued by critics with such a concern for new forms, structures and sounds that they negated the possibility of it having even the slightest impact, emotionally. It was a very powerful record; it applied pressure and release, it dealt with topics as necessary as they were "uncool" ... It was an album with implications far wider than seemed possible at the time.

Best summarised by 'Gypsy Blood's own 'Strip-show' — *"I'll give you something that you can't ignore / I'll give you something you've been searching for"* — it was a debut of disturbing honesty and relentless pain. It was life and hurt and confusion and love and violence and self-honesty. It was Doll By Doll, and it still bites.

The almost relaxed, plush surface of 'Gypsy Blood' belies the deep insight it facilitates — not only into the personalities and experiences of Doll By Doll, but into one's own. It depends how honest you are with yourself.

'Gypsy Blood' is an album of delicate subtlety. Its *apparent* accessibility is deceptive, but its ultimate rewards are limitless. It's an album where Doll By Doll unload joy and tragedy from their past without over - personalising their subject matter or overstepping the border between intensity and shock - effect.

Jo Shaw's 'Endgame', for instance, is a song of grief and hope, resulting from his involvement with the heroin culture. It examines, with a terrified unrelenting application, the destruction and degradation heroin has become synonymous with:

"Tonight we hear a shout / girl got taken out / by the devil's triangle / stuff they could not handle / deep down inside I hear her cry."

Similarly, 'Binary Fiction' questions the concept of marriage as a sturdy, solidly - founded institution, its *actual* insecurities ... it's a result of broken marriage. A song of self - assertion and deceiving optimism; the perception and relevance of much of 'Gypsy Blood' is as emotionally real as The Fall's cryptic quirkiness is direct and cutting.

Just like the sub-garageband sound of 'Dragnet' needs fighting if anything is to be retrieved, the Sinclair - produced gloss of 'Gypsy Blood' needs conquering before its absolute worth becomes apparent; the material does not necessitate "Production" but when you're dealing with emotions rather than strategic statements, it helps and emphasises.

The mysteries of 'Gypsy Blood' do not deter; they encapsulate, they invite, they consume. If "reality" is a deterrent, then that itself speaks volumes of our frightened, misconceived, abused rock and roll culture.

"I often wonder just what is going on / I turn away from the headlights / I'm sick and tired of the same old song"

Remember Doll By Doll still haven't gone away. Now what are you going to do with them? ✦✦✦✦

CHRIS WESTWOOD



JACKIE LEVEN of Doll by Doll

FUNKADELIC: 'Uncle Jam Wants You' (Warner Bros K56712)

READY TO go on groove manoeuvres? Good, 'cos Uncle Jam wants you to funk with him. After all, it is the American heritage, according to George Clinton, the freak with more alter egos than the worst schizo in the street.

Last year the Funkadelic battle campaign was based on the ideal of having one nation under a groove. This year the plan is to "Rescue Dance Music From The Blahs". No, I don't understand either, but once again this is marvellously enjoyable comic book funk. Aside from the "Exclamation of Funkatation", the "Funk Army" and all the other lunacy, Clinton and the gang really do believe in funk as a religion.

'One Nation' was, I suggest, THE funk single of '78, and the monster on this album is '(Not Just) Knee Deep', a whole 15 minutes of clapping, whooping, freaking — the Funkadelic / Parliament sound is an unusually complex one and often requires patience, but give this track, and the rest, a play or three and you'll be well away.

'Freak Of The Weeek' is a slower, almost sensible piece, like the instrumental, electric 'Field Manoeuvres'. There's a ballad, 'Holly Wants To Go To California' ("Holly would," y'see?) and more freakin' with 'Uncle Jam' and 'Foot Soldiers (Star-Spangled Funky)'. They're real funk junkies, these guys and gals. ✦✦✦✦

PAUL SEXTON

VARIOUS ARTISTS: 'Identity Parade' (TJM TJML1)

A SLEEVE note that goes "Punk is dead ... VIVA LA REVOLUTION"?

Manchester indulging in self-back-patting frolics, lumping their brave new talents into one labbo "new" music statement??

Are these limp-dingus V2s, Mellotrons and Direct Hits the "catalysts of the future" (sleeve note) with their self-consciously different, awfully Mancunian alternative-like plonkings???

Is Manchester a myth????

Are there too many question marks here?????

"It's a band with a scummy-sensationalist name like Genocide playing like they're trying to merit their monicker. Speed playing half-paced un-speedlike "tough" pop, Eddie Mooney with his deeply cutting disco-goer analysis, nomads like She Cracked, Sister Ray, Steroid Kids and The Teardrops — good, very Manchester-like names for Manchester bands. It's a tidy, calculated TJM package for people who think they like the idea of alternatives but don't know why: all voice-of-the-nation's-youth, snore, etcetera. ✦✦

CHRIS WESTWOOD

GLADIATORS: 'Sweet So Till' (Front Line FL1048)

BEING a Studio One prodigy, the Gladiators are not considered totally unhip by reggae cognoscenti, just a little MOR. Their cheerful, optimistic tunes have something of the effect of a chinese meal — half an hour later you're hungry again.

There's nothing here as good as 'Naturality' or 'Struggle' from their last album of 10 months ago, but on the whole they maintain their high standards. The first time self-production job seems to have done no damage, and Albert Griffiths' voice has lost none of its character, even if the title track is blighted by an attack of syndrum.

But the PR handout conveniently points out (inadvertently) the trouble with this album: "it's guaranteed to keep us sweet until the next album arrives". Aye, and by my reckoning that should be in about 20 minutes time. ✦✦✦½

ALEX SKORECKI



JOHN SHEARLAW, before the strain of News Editor made his hair fall out by the handful.



SINGLES

1	INTO THE VALLEY/TV STARS, The Skids	Virgin
2	STOP YOUR SOBBING, The Pretenders	Real
3	PART TIME PUNKS/WHERE'S BILL GRUNDY NOW, TV Personalities	Rough Trade
4	QUE SERA (MI VIDA), Gibson Brothers	Island
5	IT DON'T MEAN NOTHING AT ALL, Valves	Albion
6	SHEET SHEET, (Live EP) UFO	Chrysalis
7	I WILL SURVIVE, Gloria Gaynor	Polydor
8	GO WEST, Village People	Mercury
9	SOLDIER SOLDIER, Spizz Energi	Rough Trade
10	SOME GIRLS, Racey	Rak

ALBUMS

1	GO WEST, Village People	Mercury
2	CUBA, Gibson Brothers	Island
3	DAYS IN EUROPA, The Skids	Virgin
4	THE UNDERTONES, The Undertones	Sire
5	CLASH, Clash	CBS-USA
6	VOULEZ-VOUZ, Abba	Epic
7	E—MC², Giorgio Moroder	DJM
8	DON'T GIVE A MONKEY'S, Chas & Dave	EMI
9	INTENSIFIED-ORIGINAL SKA 1962-65, Various Artists Compilation	Island
10	REBEL MUSIC, Various Artists Compilation	Trojan

WORST ALBUM: REPLICAS, Tubeway Army
WORST SINGLE: MESSAGE IN A BOTTLE, Police
BEST LIGS: Chas and Dave's 'Piss up in a Brewery'
BEST GIGS: Abba (The Magnificent), RDS, Dublin
BIGGEST PAINS IN THE NECK: (Well, the crutch actually) Lyn's trouser's tread trade mark)
HOPE FOR THE EIGHTIES: World domination by Doll By Doll

SIMON LUDGATE, main star and most intelligent person on the paper. (I also write the captions.)



SINGLES

1	POP MUSIK, M	RCA
2	LIFE IN A DAY, Simple Minds	Virgin
3	I HEARD IT THROUGH THE GRAPEVINE (B-SIDE OF TYPICAL GIRLS), Slits	Island
4	KNOCK ON WOOD, Amii Stewart	WEA
5	THE SHAPE OF THINGS TO COME, Headboys	RSO
6	ON MY RADIO, Selecter	2-Tone
7	TOURIST, Gang Of Four	EMI
8	WHAT'S A MATTER BABY, Ellen Foley	Epic
9	GANGSTERS, Specials	2-Tone
10	BREAKING DOWN THE WALLS OF HEARTACHE, Jane Aire And The Belvederes	Virgin

ALBUMS

1	SPECIALS, Specials	2-Tone
2	ENTERTAINMENT, Gang Of Four	EMI
3	NIGHTOUT, Ellen Foley	Epic
4	HIGHWAY TO HELL, AC/DC	WEA
5	THE WALL, Pink Floyd	Harvest
6	THE SHAPE OF THINGS TO COME, Headboys	RSO
7	ZOOM, Root Boy Slim And The Sex Change Band	Illegal
8	GYPSY BLOOD, Doll By Doll	Automatic
9	INTO THE MUSIC, VAN MORRISON	Phonogram
10	I AM, Earth, Wind And Fire	CBS

BEST LIG: Chrysalis party at The Plaza for Hunter and Ronson, when Ronson almost destroyed the restaurant single-handed
BEST GIG: Gang of Four at the Electric Ballroom
WORST ALBUMS: DRAGNET, The Fall. BOMBER, Motorhead. PLEASURE PRINCIPLE, Gary Numan
WORST SINGLES: WANTED, The Dooleys. I WILL SURVIVE, Gloria Gaynor. BOMBER, Motorhead
BIGGEST PAIN IN THE NECK: Duffo, with Ayatollah Khomeini running a close second
HOPE FOR THE EIGHTIES: Bill Haley

DANIELA SOAVE on one of many visits to hospital kitchens. The dead mackerel is NOT Gary Numan.



SINGLES

1	POP MUSIK, M	MCA
2	MAKING PLANS FOR NIGEL, XTC	Virgin
3	I ONLY WANT TO BE WITH YOU, Tourists	Logo
4	ANGEL EYES, Roxy Music	Polydor
5	IN THE BROWNIES, Billy Connolly	Polydor
6	INTO THE VALLEY, Skids	Virgin
7	STRANGE TOWN, Jam	Polydor
8	KID, Pretenders	Real Records
9	GIMME GIMME GIMME, Abba	Epic
10	CHUCK E'S IN LOVE, Rikki Lee Jones	Warner Bros

ALBUMS

1	SQUEEZING OUT SPARKS, Graham Parker	Vertigo
2	SCARED TO DANCE, Skids	Virgin
3	REPEAT WHEN NECESSARY, Dave Edmunds	Swansong
4	LIVE RUST, Neil Young	Warner Brothers
5	INTO THE MUSIC, Van Morrison	Mercury
6	BOP TILL YOU DROP, Ry Cooder	Warner Brothers
7	SETTING SONS, Jam	Polydor
8	REGATTA DE BLANC, Police	A&M
9	GYPSY BLOOD, Doll By Doll	Automatic
10	A GLINT AT THE KINDLING, Robin Williamson	Criminal

BEST LIGS: None.
BEST GIGS: Skids — Loch Lomond Festival. Boomtown Rats — New York Palladium
WORST SINGLE: ONE DAY AT A TIME, Lena Martell
WORST ALBUM: DO IT YOURSELF, Ian Dury
PAIN IN THE NECK: More mass-manufactured music, ie mod
HOPES FOR THE EIGHTIES: When I think about the past year there's very little about it which excites me, all my faves are mostly continuations from 1978.

GRAHAM STEVENS, apart from being Art Ed, is a part-time student of the black arts. He also likes cooking, sewing and meeting people.



SINGLES

1	MAKING PLANS FOR NIGEL, XTC	Virgin
2	ETON RIFLES, Jam	Polydor
3	HIGHWAY TO HELL, AC/DC	WEA
4	I DON'T LIKE MONDAYS, Boomtown Rats	Ensign
5	ARE FRIENDS ELECTRIC, Gary Numan	Beggar's Banquet
5	WORKING FOR THE YANKEE DOLLAR, Skids	Virgin
7	OUT OF CONTROL, U2	O'CBS
8	ONE STEP BEYOND, Madness	Stiff
9	MONEY, Flying Lizards	Virgin
10	ROXANNE, Police	A&M

ALBUMS

1	HIGHWAY TO HELL, AC/DC	WEA
2	SHEIK YERBOUTI, Frank Zappa	CBS
3	IN STYLE, David Johansen	Blue Sky
4	GYPSY BLOOD, Doll By Doll	Automatic
5	ONE STEP BEYOND, Madness	Stiff
6	NIGHT OUT, Ellen Foley	Epic
7	DAYS IN EUROPA, Skids	Virgin
8	SECRETS, Robert Palmer	Island
9	INTO THE MUSIC, Van Morrison	Phonogram
10	LASER LOVE, After The Fire	CBS

BEST GIGS: AC/DC — Hammersmith Odeon
BEST LIG: What's that?
WORST SINGLE: CHRISTMAS DITTIE, Paul McCartney
WORST ALBUM: SLOW TRAIN COMING, Bob Dylan
PAIN IN THE NECK: Anne Nightingale
HOPE FOR THE EIGHTIES: that Shearlaw is pensioned off finally

ROBIN SMITH hasn't changed much. Bit uglier, I suppose.



SINGLES

1	I NEED A LOVER, Johnny Cougar	Riva
2	I WAS MADE FOR LOVING YOU, Kiss	Casablanca
3	I BELIEVE IN FATHER CHRISTMAS, Greg Lake	Manticore
4	BANG BANG, BA Robertson	Asylum
5	I DON'T LIKE MONDAYS, Boomtown Rats	Ensign
6	COME ON, Wishbone Ash	MCA
7	WASTED, Def Leppard	Ensign
8	GIRLS GOT RHYTHM, AC/DC	Atlantic
9	IT'S DIFFERENT FOR GIRLS, Joe Jackson	A&M
10	ETON RIFLES, Jam	Polydor

ALBUMS

1	IN THROUGH THE OUT DOOR, Led Zeppelin	Swansong
2	52ND STREET, Billy Joel	CBS
3	GYPSY BLOOD, Doll By Doll	Automatic
4	STREET MACHINE, Sammy Hagar	Capitol
5	THE STEVE HOWE ALBUM, Steve Howe	Atlantic
6	NEW ENGLAND, New England	Infinity
7	LIVE RUST, Neil Young	Reprise
8	DYNASTY, Kiss	Casablanca
9	TUSK, Fleetwood Mac	Reprise
10	GREATEST HITS, Chic	Atlantic

BEST GIG: Led Zeppelin, Knebworth
BEST LIG: Being shy and retiring I didn't go to many and can't remember anything particularly outstanding
WORST SINGLE: WONDERFUL CHRISTMASTIME, Paul McCartney
WORST ALBUM: HIGH WIND, High Wind
PAIN IN THE NECK: Paul McCartney
HOPE FOR THE EIGHTIES: Doll By Doll

CHRIS WESTWOOD. A "dog" amongst "men" if "ever" I "saw" "one". (What do I "mean" by that?)



SINGLES

1	UGLY MAN, Transmitters	Step Forward
2	THE FOUNTAIN IS RED, Doll By Doll	Automatic B-Side
3	SYMPHONIE DE THING, Monochrome Set	Rough Trade
4	THE FORCE IS BLIND, ATV	Deptford Fun City
5	ROWCHE RUMBLE, The Fall	Step Forward
6	BEYOND GOOD AND EVIL, The Pop Group	Radar
7	A QUESTION OF DEGREE, Wire	Harvest
8	THREE U-2	CBS Ireland Import
9	FAIRYTALE IN THE SUPERMARKET, The Raincoats	Rough Trade

ALBUMS

1	REMEMBER, Doll By Doll	Automatic
2	GYPSY BLOOD, Doll By Doll	Automatic
3	DRAGNET, The Fall	Step Forward
4	ENTERTAINMENT, Gang Of Four	EMI
5	VIBING UP THE SENILE MAN, ATV	Deptford Fun City
6	UNKNOWN PLEASURES, Joy Division	Factory
7	LIVE AT THE WITCH TRIALS, The Fall	Step Forward
8	METAL BOX, Pil	Virgin
9	Y, The Pop Group	Radar
10	BOP TILL YOU DROP, Ry Cooder	Warner Bros

BEST GIGS: Doll By Doll, York Pop Club
BEST LIGS: None
WORST ALBUM: What does "worst" mean anyway?
WORST SINGLE: The choice is really difficult, since absolutely everything released this year was just sooo good. Again: what does "worst" mean anyway?? (Shut up, Chris — Redundant Mailman.)
PAIN IN THE NECK: Ian Page
HOPES FOR EIGHTIES: Excitement. Realism. Conflict. U-2

RONNIE GURR. He said, "It was taken at Edinburgh zoo, if that's any help." Before or after he escaped?



SINGLES

1	BOYS DON'T CRY, The Cure	Fiction
2	MAKING PLANS FOR NIGEL, XTC	Virgin
3	WORKING FOR THE YANKEE DOLLAR, The Skids	Virgin
4	DANCE AWAY, Roxy Music	Polydor
5	HOLD THE LINE, Toto	CBS
6	TURN ON THE RADIO, The Rollers	Arista
7	STRANGE TOWN, Jam	Polydor
8	REVOLT INTO STYLE, Bill Nelson's Red Noise	Harvest
9	MADNESS/THE PRINCE, Madness	2 Tone
10	I WILL SURVIVE, Gloria Gaynor	Polydor

ALBUMS

1	DRUMS AND WIRES, XTC	Virgin
2	NIGHT OUT, Ellen Foley	Epic
3	SETTING SONS, The Jam	Polydor
4	EVEN SERPENTS SHINE, The Undertones	Sire
5	SCARED TO DANCE IN EUROPA, The Skids	Virgin
6	THE UNDERTONES, The Undertones	Sire
7	UNDER INFLUENCE, The Zones	Arista
8	YOU'RE NEVER ALONE WITH SCHIZOPHRENIC, Ian Hunter	Chrysalis
9	BAD GIRLS, Donna Summer	Casablanca
10	FEAR OF MUSIC, Talking Heads	Sire

BEST GIGS: Bruce Springsteen at the Musicians United for Safe Energy gig in Madison Square Garden, New York.
BEST LIGS: Stuart Adamson's 21st birthday.
WORST ALBUM: VAN HALEN II, Van 'Please Don't Hit Me' Halen. A gem
WORST SINGLES: HERE COMES SUMMER, Child. NEVER GONNA FALL IN LOVE, Tom Robinson. GERTCHA, Chas & Dave
PAINS IN THE NECK: Rock journalists, the Ayatollah, Margaret Thatcher, Ernest Postheltwaite, Gary Numan, Roberto Rosselini
HOPE FOR THE EIGHTIES: That Village People will become victims of genocidal atrocities

PAUL SEXTON. If you want a disco record reviewed this is your man. Even if you don't he still is.



SINGLES

1	WE DON'T TALK ANY MORE, Cliff Richard	EMI
2	WHAT YOU WON'T DO FOR LOVE, Bobby Caldwell	TK
3	MINUTE BY MINUTE, The Doobie Brothers	Warner Bros
4	WHAT A FOOL BELIEVES, The Doobie Brothers	Warner
5	AQUA BOOGIE, Parliament	Casablanca
6	STILL, Commodores	Motown
7	SAIL ON, The Commodores	Motown
8	I NEED YOUR HELP BARRY MANILOW, Ray Stevens	Warner Bros
9	HERE COMES THE NIGHT, The Beach Boys	Caribou
10	(NOT JUST) KNEE DEEP, Funkadelic	Warner Bros

ALBUMS

1	LA (LIGHT ALBUM), The Beach Boys	Caribou
2	BOBBY CALDWELL, Bobby Caldwell	TK
3	FLAG, James Taylor	CBS
4	THE SECRET LIFE OF PLANTS, Stevie Wonder	Motown
5	UNCLE JAM WANTS YOU, Funkadelic	Warner Bros
6	PATRICE, Patrice Rushen	Elektra
7	FEETS DON'T FAIL ME NOW, Herbie Hancock	CBS
8	IN THE HEAT OF THE NIGHT, Pat Benatar	Chrysalis
9	NO MORE FEAR OF FLYING, Gary Brooker	Chrysalis
10	WELCOME TO THE CRUISE, Judie Tzuke	Rocket

BEST GIGS: Joe Jackson (Marquee, February)
BEST LIGS: The trip to Paris for the DISCOM exhibition in October was better than pleasant, but for sheer alcoholic haziness it has to be the "wake" for Popstar at Crawford's Wine Bar in June. (If anyone out there still remembers the much-missed mag — Simon and Danny, you don't count — I was Geoff Calvert, by the way.)
WORST SINGLE: HOORAY IT's A HOLI HOLIDAY, Boney M
WORST ALBUM: BOOGIE WOOGIE DANCIN' SHOES, Claudja Barry
BIGGEST PAIN IN THE NECK: People who slag off Record Mirror when they haven't read a copy properly for five years.

CAUGHT IN THE ACT

ECHO & THE BUNNYMEN
Lyceum, London

THE Bunnymen's first gig of a national tour neither confirmed nor denied their ability to capture the magical depth and aching despair attained on their stunning debut album "Crocodiles".

This confusing ambiguity arose because, while some of the stronger tracks suffered in their live form, their edge disappearing in the flow of dry ice across the stage, some of the weaker songs, such as "Happy Death Men", actively improved when played with more aggression and attack.

Pete De Freitas' drums are now both solid and far reaching, a perfect bedrock for Les Pattinson's booming funk bass lines. Together they have mastered the art of using space as a positive dynamic in a rhythmic structure that evolves in a masterfully planned dialectic.

Diving through this echoing beat, Will Sergeant wanders into territory normally exclusive to Bob Fripp, sometimes slashing everything into segments or soaring off into the distance. Covering this vast expanse of jagged power, Ian McCulloch sings with the rich depth that suggests he is the only person capable of filling the gap left by the untimely death of Ian Curtis.

The new single, "The Puppet", is more rock solid than the previous "Rescue"; on first hearing it sounds a worthy successor. "Vilber's Terrace" and "Going Up" ring through the head long after they're over, like some insidious tape loop of strange horrors.

Likewise, "Monkeys" and "Crocodiles" are equally impressive. The hunger behind this music transcends the depressions it deals with and although still flawed there are few bands anywhere who come close to the vistas the Bunnymen dare reach.

Miss this tour and you'll miss something very special. – IAN PYE.

Telekinetic disturbance

GARY NUMAN
Odeon, Birmingham

THE low-rent metropolis chic of Birmingham's city heart, designed for cars not people, must seem like a second home for the leading pop-futurist of the UK's new android musik.

Strangers to this tangled mass of fly-overs, precincts and walkways could easily find themselves driving endlessly through the concrete and glass labyrinth humming "Are Friends Electric".

A faceless Odeon is filled by hordes of black uniforms (set off by a red flash or white tie), mostly on young girls who periodically crack their hypnotic stares to scream like 21st century teenyboppers. Futurism it may be, but beneath all the white make-up and neo-military attire it's plain old teenage adulation.

And the object of worship is a small anaemic figure in a red boiler suit who totters about the stage on three inch heels, rarely smiling but always posing. Numan has become the epicentre of a musical vogue, that in keeping with our brave new world, sounds as if it were composed by computers, played by robots, and bought by mates.

From an original idea by Kraftwerk, later adapted by Bowie, the synth dominated style has been cloned repeatedly. And just as Cliff Richard once led a small, though easily identified, group of early British rockers aping their American heroes, Gary Numan spearheads the secondhand machine age of pop.

The parallel doesn't stop there, however, because in common with Cliff, Gary presents a safe, sanitised version of male sexuality – there can't be a parent around who would object to his cold visage plastered up on their daughter's bedroom wall.

Such an observation is borne out watching him reel out the amorphous compositions from "Telekon", punctuated by his greatest hits. Few concessions are made towards fuelling the libido, aside from an occasional token pelvic thrust, or the use of a black guitar as a phallic prop. Perhaps then, it's the feeling of seeing an untouchable visitor from Planet X that excites the passions of so many screaming girls, prompting them to pass secret notes and clamouring to touch him.

They even manage to break his studied cool: "You've never heard me talk before have you?" he says before stuffing love letters in between one of his many zips. Each song ends in a blackout and overbearing silence, before more hypnotic staring and another backdrop of strident synth and automated rhythms. It's as bleak and scary as watching Andy Pandy.

Bassist Paul Gardener and drummer Ced Sharpley, perched on a twin pedestal, under which Gary appears near the show's climax in a black electric chair, never falter. And Russell Bell on guitar and synth player Chris Payne, enclosed in a swinging-Sixties' deejay booth, perform all that's asked of them. Coupled with the obligatory dry ice and flashing lights it's all a bit like "Dr Who", with Tom Baker out to lunch.

Driving through Birmingham's wastelands, an experience infinitely more chilling than a brush with Numan's music, a radio wit suggests that this year's model was constructed by a couple of jokers at Texas Instruments during their tea break. They'd furiously disagree back at the Odeon, where Numan plays two encores, security guards yanking back fragile bodies to the strains of "We Are Glass".

Everybody seems well satisfied with the generous, lenthy set. Gary leaves to get ready for the final evening performance – it must be quite a strain on the poor boy. Of course, there's always the final solution, more relevant every day as the cost of touring soars, he could walk on, introduce a video of the band and their leader, call it "The Man Who Fell To Earth Part 2", and leave the rest to the rampant imagination of modern youth. – IAN PYE.



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At the sign of the Black Horse

LLOYDS BANK

AL HAIG DUO
Pizza On The Park, London

A touch glacial in demeanour, the distinguished American pianist Al Haig presents an image that is a complete antithesis to the picture usually evoked by bebop heroes.

After all, he was Charlie Parker's pianist in the heady days of bebop jet sports no goatee, dresses conservatively and has a shy, almost introspective bandstand persona.

Even so, his music as offered to an attentive audience last Saturday, has about it much of the harmonic adventure and sheer joyous fluency of bebop, coupled in Haig's case with a carryover of swing-style keyboard facility that reminded me of Teddy Wilson's controlled yet heated performances.

Sustained by a superb Yamaha grand and supported by the excellent bassist Dennis Irwin, a former Art Blakey sideman, Haig gave us a kind of concert in miniature. His lengthy sets comprised a crafty amalgam of bop originals ("Night In Tunisia", modern jazz themes ("Oleo" by Rollins) and lesser heard standards; the pacing lending a thread of surprise to the whole endeavour, as he varied tempo and touch in an intelligently conceived statement of his art.

He has the means to forage in lush, sometimes romantic territory but will then switch abruptly to cleanly articulated, single-note lines, as on Bud Powell's "Dance Of The Infidels" which swung easily, and Monk's "Off Minor" whose quirky harmonies permitted him ample opportunity to show his quick-witted yet very reactions.

At Haig's work is marked by a sense of order that may sometimes mask its passionate content: his improvisations seeming to fall on the ear as though composed on the page. His is the jazz art that conceals art – splendid creativity accompanied by a degree of deliberate formalism. He has refined his playing to a point where he achieves a momentum that beautifully exploits the piano's orchestral capability while he adds right-hand figures of direct, horn-like vigour.

Keith Sawbridge, a London pianist less often seen in a jazz context, alternated his style more florid than that of Haig, he also impressed with Hines-like dynamics and deserves to be heard again. – PETER VACHER

DOLL BY DOLL,
The Castle, Richmond

DOLL By Doll are so enigmatic it hurts. They continue to confound and disturb, veering from twisted layers of screaming noise, almost painful in magnitude, to exquisite moments of dazzling innovation which threaten to fulfil the astonishing promise shown when they first came under the media's eye.

The early gigs were received with the enthusiasm of the converted, supported by a mystique that slowly evolved around their lyrics, redolent with literary references and dark psychological confessions. Jackie Leven emerged as a forceful, charismatic figure.

"Remember", their first album was typically confusing, containing passages that only hinted at the band's live presence. Some commercial credibility was regained after their second album "Gypsy Blood". It contained some excellent songs, although it again paled in comparison to their frequently stunning live performances.

At Richmond a dodgy PA coupled with an initially fuzzy mix only marginally marred a performance of consuming passion. Despite the absence of clear vocals and unsophisticated lighting the band still came home with a vengeance.

On songs like "Teenage Lightning" and "Strip Show" they explored territories few will have heard before. Leven's voice soars over the top like a prehistoric bird as he cries on "Lightning": "If you go walking in the street today Be sure and listen what the young boys say They know the colour of speed is red You don't become a hero till you've bled."

Jo Shaw has evolved into a guitarist of hypnotic intensity and breathtaking range. Behind Leven's vast banks of rippling electronic sound he picks out penetrating lines, the whole running over drummer Dave McIntosh's and bass player Tony Waite's insistent rhythm.

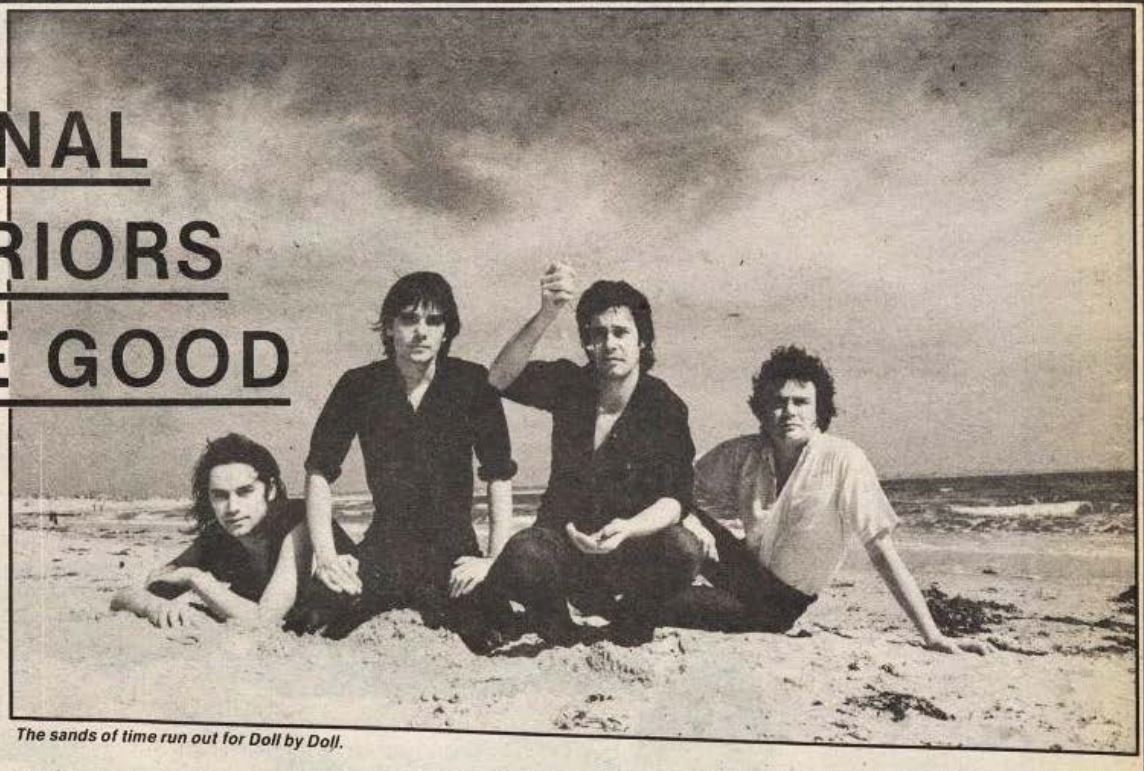
Only Leven's fear of sounding familiar prevented them from fully relaxing into the veins of white soul that run through their music. Everything is delivered with a glowering, menace occasionally punctuated by the band's exclusive, whispered conversations.

Slow, curling intros establish the mood of much of their material before giving way to a creeping menace coming from behind to grip like a vice. "For my gift is a poison That shall conquer all Who hear the secret call In the city of triangles Every gate shall fall," ("Hell Games).

Now that bands like Joy Division and Echo And The Bunnymen have opened the way for new music of risks and adventures, Doll By Doll should, if there's any justice, have their day.

Enduring with "Piece Of Love" they left amidst a tangle of retching feedback. Leven stood transfixed, glaring into the distance one last time before he led the band quickly away. – IAN PYE.

ETERNAL WARRIORS MAKE GOOD



The sands of time run out for Doll by Doll.

DOLL BY DOLL: 'Doll by Doll' (Magnet MAGL 5039)
By Mark Cooper

DOLL BY Doll's romanticism is the kind in which only the roughest men indulge. It takes a lot to laugh, it takes a train to cry. Women are worshipped and then dismissed, all inside Doll by Doll's claustrophobic sense of the drama of their own feelings. Their sound is that of powerful violent men whose toughness is measured in proportion to their capacity to weep at folk ballads and sorrow over their beer.

Doll By Doll's last album 'Remember' came out a good two years ago on a different label. Finally here's the third album released by that astute pop company, Magnet. This is a shimmering, designed work that hasn't lost the band's rough, spontaneous edges so much as disciplined and directed them.

The band's trademarks remain the same. The pounding drums, the vocal breaks and sudden handclap choruses, the lyricism and repressed anger are all here, present and correct. Jackie Leven remains a truly *strong* voice, combining raw blues and Drifters' sweet romanticism, deep bass and clear falsetto. Leven unites the early and late Van Morrison, the R&B singer of Them and the later pastoral mystic. Once again these trademarks are allowed to exercise over a wide variety of musical styles and echoes but in a more compact manner than before.

As usual, Doll By Doll sing of deep matters in a poetry that has roots in a brutal, mythic folk past and is content, for the most part, to remain obscure. There's sudden switches between the tender stand - out ballad 'Main Travelled Roads', that makes fine use of 'The Twelfth Of Never' melody, the gay shuffle of 'Those In Peril' and the semi-disco pulse of 'Caritas'. The handclaps figure throughout to recall sixties dance music here turned to heavier, darker purposes. Despite the exuberance, this music never quite overcomes its brooding, sorrowful quality.

The mood throughout is Doll By Doll intense but it's an intensity that permits the celebration of birth that is the humble 'Soon New Life' and the folk tenderness of 'Main Travelled Roads'. All in all, then, this record has an electric vision and a unity of purpose with a pop cleanliness that Doll By Doll have never previously achieved. Perhaps now the pirates will stand aside for the sorrowing warriors. As Jackie Leven has it, "Eternal is the warrior who finds beauty in his wounds." Beauty eternal. + + + +

JEFFERSON STARSHIP: 'Modern Times' (RCALP 5027)
By Malcolm Dome

I RECKON that you will not hear a finer exposition of the AOR genre during 1981. The crisp vocal harmonies (augmented by the return of Grace Slick), allied to some potent guitar work from both Craig Chaquico and the ever dependable Paul Kantner, plus the David Frieberg / Pete Sears keyboard axis gives every composition the hallmark of solid silver spectacle.

The supine melody of the current single 'Find Your Way Back', the smartly pugilistic nuances of Mickey Thomas and Ms Slick during 'Stranger', the unforgettably climactic instrumental apocalypse that ends 'Save Your Love' and the evocative, immortal, loneliness of 'Alien' (out - flashing Queen) are just a random selection of sensational samples.

However, THE priceless cut in a set of polydecibel gems is the title track. A tale of modern anarchy and pathos ("Outside 12 - year - olds are carrying machine guns / I must be dreaming"), it is driven along via an astonishingly concussive drum foundation laid down by Aynsley Dunbar. If ever a song was destined to become an international anthem of Pulitzer proportions then this is it.

Yes, infidels, with 'MT', Jefferson Starship have created arguably the best album since their metamorphosis. + + + + +

CUDDLY TOYS 'Guillotine Theatre' (Fresh FRESHLP I)
By Chas de Whalley

EVERYTHING ABOUT Cuddly Toys is David Bowie circa the Ziggy Stardust and Diamond Dogs era. The singer, the songs, the sound and hte glam rock image all conspire to put back the clock by the best part of 10 years but fail to evoke anything more than the limp - wristed attitude dancing that was every college disco in 1973.

Every hair is in place and nobody's eye make - up is smudged, which is tribute perhaps to the immense care and not little expense that has gone into Cuddly Toys quite excellently packaged debut album. But the inspiration, the menace and the measure of millenium which made Ziggy such a classic is at best merely simulated notes - by - numbers on 'Guillotine Theatre' and at worst is totally lost in a schoolboy thrash. +

BARCLAY JAMES HARVEST: 'Turn Of The Tide' (Polydor POLD 5040)
By Robin Smith

YOUR USUAL dollop of cosmic cliches, packaged in a sleeve with a butterfly on the cover and watery surreal outlines. Cor blimey Guv, what symbolism.

Peace, love and watch the bank balances rise as BJH turn out another bestseller, especially in greater Europe where they're absolutely *huge*, darlings. By now you must know how it is with BJH — predictions on the state of the world tempered with flowery mush.

But you've got to hand it to them, as hippy revivalists go they have few equals. For consistency but a distinct lack of innovation BJH score. + +

OSIBISA 'Mystic Energy' (Calibre CABLP 1002)
BLACK SLATE: 'Ogima' (Spartan TCDLP2)
By Simon Tebbutt

"YEARS OF mystical energy / Have gone into making / The instinctive genuine, vibrant and happy music / Of the Osibisounds."

A bit over the top perhaps, but true in essence. Osibisa have spent the last decade or so perfecting their sound. A cross cultural fusion of African ethnic beats and American / European influences and instruments that makes a honkey out of that also swang Adam Ant.

'Meeting Point' comes on as primeval jazz rock with a pulsating rhythm that lasts the whole album. And 'Celebration' is its epitomy, a joyous good time number that blends all the diverse elements into one uplifting sound. This infectious quality is carried through the chants of 'Oreba (Magic People)', the funky solid 'Moving On', the light and airey 'Mama (I Will Be Back)' to the calypso beat 'Fatima / Obinkabimame'. Even 'Africa We Gogo' avoids crass political posturing and leaves the impression that life's worth living for all its injustices.

Black Slate is more restrained and more weird altogether. It sounds a little like a reggae experiment in the BBC Sound Effects studio. The only thing in common with Osibisa is the horns and the chunky, flicking guitar rhythms.

Black Slate lack the hooks of what is considered commercial reggae and more than 30 minutes can be a little tedious. But that's probably because it's dance music for enjoyment rather than analysis. + + + + and + +

SNAKEFINGER: 'Greener Postures' (Do It RIDE 5)
By Winston Smith

THE SNAKEFINGER story begins in 1971 when ex-Chilli Willi guitarist Phillip Lithman left his native England to team up with the mysterious Residents in San Francisco. It was here that Lithman was re-christened Snakefinger by a member of the group because of his "serpent-like fingers".

'Greener Postures' (the second Snakefinger album) has been available through Ralph Records on import since September. Now it's available in the UK and must *not* be missed.

Snakefinger creates a unique, and yes, somewhat whacky sound. This is at it's most dramatic on the album's raunchiest number, 'I Come From An Island'. On 'Island' the guitar sounds gritty and at times, almost psychedelic. This bubbles along nicely upon an irresistable bouncy disco rhythm.

'Save Me From Dali' is an aural nightmare, chocablock with hideous ghostly Hawaiian guitarists, and subversive clockwork monkeys.

'Living In Vain' is reminiscent of early Alice Cooper, while the epic 'Pictures Makers Vs The Children Of The Sea' is a jarring tale of conflict between good and evil. It's quite stunning. Close your eyes and let your imagination decide who is to win the battle!

Produced by the Residents, 'Greener Postures' is a treat. I just wish Snakefinger didn't sound so much like Tom Robinson on Sinex. + + + + ½



Pic by Joe Bangor

Classix Nouveaux and friends.

HARDLY CLASSICS

CLASSIX NOUVEAUX: 'Night People' Liberty (LBG 30325)
By Mark Total

SUPERFLUITY flows from every pore of Classix Nouveau's first album, trying to give the band an aura of grandeur that they have yet to earn.

Many people could argue that one of Classix's main strengths is the vocals of Sal Solo, but to me he sounds too much like Demis Roussos for comfort. There are two fine instrumentals on 'Foreward' and '623', respectively, and it's up to the listener to savour what they can from Solo's voice.

Having tried to annihilate Solo's singing capabilities I should really put the whole thing into perspective and say how much I admire the way he writes. 'Guilty' (a solo Solo composition) never did achieve the mega - hit status it deserved, but there are two songs that nearly match up to that on here — 'No Sympathy, No Violins' is one and 'Every Home Should Have One' the other. They are both co-written with bass / synthesist Mik (pretence again) Sweeney and the criteria of whether Classix will develop depends on the two's ability to progress. They should channel their energies away from trite rubbish like 'Run Away' and 'Tokyo' which brings their whole grand image down to earth.

If they want to attain the greatness of a band like Ultravox (which isn't a bad thing) they ought to concentrate on writing masterpieces instead of synthesised doggerel, but that shouldn't give them a licence to be self - indulgent. Their one main strength is that they don't over emphasise a point.

That's the end of the pep talk boys, now go out and do it.
File under "Matters Pending" + + ½.

Gigs

PINK FLOYD
Earls Court, London
By Mark Cooper

PINK FLOYD'S 'The Wall' is the ultimate rock concert, more a funeral than a celebration. 'The Wall' will not end because it is already dead. So are huge rock concerts and 'The Wall' knows this fact, takes it as one of its subjects. 'The Wall' takes place in Roger Water's brain. Inside Earls Court, you are inside his skull with its traditional English images of the enemy, skoolteachers, wives, mothers and the British Pig, straight from 1984. So take your seat, sit back and be entertained, it's all theatre.

'The Wall' is the culmination of the massive rock concert and it shows in what direction it's been tending. The crowd watch the Pink Floyd with mouths open, lost in awe like tourists in Disneyland. Every 10 minutes another spectacular effect is produced — a puppet to the side of the stage, an aeroplane whizzing over head. Jaws remain loose, we're immobilised in our seats. The Floyd are the passive side of rock, quite knowingly so, and the large concert is the type of this passivity. They wallow in their ever so English fatalism and we wallow too. 'The Wall' offers an analysis of the trauma that has rendered post-war Britain, rock and roll and the Pink Floyd's generation into a state of catatonia. Unfortunately, there's little difference between the analysis and the disease.

Rock concerts this size are no longer tribal celebrations but affairs of order, events in which a parable of social control is enacted. Signs decorate Earls Court showing the consumer where to drink, where to piss, where to sit. Water's imagination is so knowing, so passively cynical, that all these criticisms and reservations of the rock concert as show are included and articulated in 'The Wall' itself. The despairing and alienated rock star retires into the wall of his own head and, lo and behold, his inner cranium becomes Earls Court. The crowd willingly enjoy his story for, as Waters claims, it is their own.

As a result, 'The Wall' paralyses, leaving no room for a reaction that hasn't been bespoken. This is a rock concert *about* rock concerts, but its critique only reproduces the disease it describes. As John Rotten once said, "Have you ever felt cheated then? Goodnight." But he destroyed the rock concert while 'The Wall' wallows in its corpse.

DEFUNKT
Venue, London
By Mike Gardner

THERE'S a new Bowie on the scene and he's just as stylish and equally as innovative. His name is Joe and his surname is pronounced "Boo-wee" but he's just as compelling.

Flanked by his white-clad band he stands on stage in a black suit, a cigarette constantly burning in his right hand and his Panama hat tipped just so and he blows trombone. Blows is not strong enough to do justice to the urgency he engenders in the full-throttled steamy cauldron of dance music that his outfit create.

The funk is hard. Hard as in strenuous, demanding, merciless, vigorous, firm and vital. The floor was packed with boppers prepared to gyrate to the razor edged R'n'B variety of swing jazz - funk.

Particularly outstanding was the superb digital gymnastics of bassist Kim Clark, the majesty of saxophonist Byron Bowie and the chunky riffing of Kelvyn Bell. But the spotlight belonged to Joe Bowie, who played his trombone sweet and spiky and urged the dancers on with his perky 'Strangling Me With Your Love', 'Thermonuclear Sweat' and his downbeat version of Chic's 'Good Times' filled with images of junkies and pushers.

Defunkt are a treat for the feet and good for the soul.



Pic by Mike Putland

Midge Ure of Ultravox joins in yawning and stretching exercises designed to keep punters awake during their set.

CRYSTAL BALLS UP

CRYSTAL PALACE GARDEN PARTY
Crystal Palace Concert Bowl, London
By Mike Gardner

THE ex-Tottenham captain and sportswriter Danny Blanchflower once observed that the Cup Final was a magnificent event and it's a pity the teams have to come out and spoil it. The same could be said of the dismal fare on offer at the 1981 Crystal Palace Garden Party.

The sun duly put its hat on and made its traditional brilliant appearance at the picturesque location. The heat was hot, the day lazy but the musical menu was too lightweight even for this salad day.

I missed Our Daughters Wedding due to the inadequacies of the Southern Region but a quick poll from punters and liggers showed that I hadn't missed much.

The Polecats confirmed my worst suspicions by making absolutely no impact either visually, by being seemingly swallowed up by the vast stage, or musically with their featherweight evocation of rockabilly. In the cramped confines of the telly or the Marquee it probably works well but with a wacking great lake between them and the scattered audience it passed like wisps of cigarette smoke, complete with a sickly aftertaste.

Next up was the wild and wacky world of Tenpole Tudor whose musical dexterity seemed to be based on the principle of the battering ram. The relentless sledgehammer tactics seemed to win converts as the hardy swam out to the front of the stage. Their wake dredged up the foul black murk that had stagnated at the bottom of the pool.

Obviously 'Swords Of A Thousand Men' went down a bundle but Tenpole got a little dirty and tacky as the funlovers pelted our manic hero with all the festering contents of the lake.

By now it had been announced that Teardrop Explodes weren't going to appear as they hadn't signed on the dotted line when the bill was announced and the rumoured Hazel O'Connor appearance wasn't going to happen either, so it was left to the nutty boys Madness to provide a musical highlight, the first of the day.

To say they failed is to call Pele a good footballer. The sound was a trebley barrage that made the much-vaunted accoustics of the Bowl seem like Waterloo Station.

Their famous sparkle fizzled with the enthusiasm of the Harlem Globetrotters at a Ku Klux Klan rally. They started with the bland tones of 'Return Of The Los Palmas 7' and surprisingly kept that tepid energy level throughout the rest of the set. 'ERNIE', 'Disappear', 'Take It Or Leave It' and even favourites like 'Baggy Trousers' seemed a grind.

Suggs sang "An earthquake is erupting, but not in Orange Street" in 'The Prince' and it was certainly not true in Crystal Palace. But 'Grey Day' was superb for all that and it was a sour epitaph for a lacklustre set.

The day was settling into languid mediocrity and judging by the green spaces in the arena most people had predicted it. I was almost praying for rain on the principle that adversity would shake up the conveyor belt of tedium.

Dance troupe Sponooch fared worst in the harsh glare of the afternoon sun. Without the impact of stage lighting the dancing looked sloppy. A Can-Can to PIL and pillow talk to James Chance's 'Stained Sheets' didn't grasp the attention and even the sole water baby at the front of the stage went for a swim. It was a sad display.

By now I was desperate for a good time and the gentle waft of a synth on a warm summers evening seemed perfect but by the time Ultravox had got to 'New Europeans' it was obvious it was not to be. As dirge followed dirge many wags were musing on how they seemed like Pink Floyd without the flying pig or a new wave Moody Blues or Barclay James Harvest.

Attention wandered to the arena where neanderthal skinheads were dragging New Romantic pretty boys into the murk of the lake. One particularly bruising looking cro-magnon stood by menacing any who tried to get out.

All was not totally yawn-inducing as 'Mr X' sounded fine but the majestic 'Vienna' proved to be the real highlight of the set but by then it meant nothing to me either.

DOLL BY DOLL
Venue, London
By Robin Smith

I FEEL like a kid who's been promised a pound of wine gums but was only given eight ounces.

This really should have been Doll By Doll's big gig. After so long underground they should have come up fighting and determined at last to start hitting mass appeal. I expected an earthquake, but all I got were a few tremors. Leven appeared to be in a petulant mood: anxious to play the bashful musician and sensitive artist.

Largely gone was that old manic style that could have you gripping the edge of your seat with your eyeballs bulging. A few old numbers like 'Palace Of Love' wouldn't have gone amiss, but instead the gig seemed to be a showcase for the new Magnet album.

D By D performed all the songs competently and Jackie's vocal range seems to be increasing year by year, but the masterpiece of 'Main Travelled Roads' was savagely cut short. Adequate but not inspired, Leven and his lads should really pull their fingers out because 1981 and the new deal is going to be make or break time for the band.

PIGBAG
Moonlight Club, London
By Jim Reid

IT'S HOT, uncomfortable: stale cheap perfume, sweaty dirty bodies, beer breath. Enter Pigbag. **(Need you say more — impressed Ed).**

They are not comforting.

With the current vogue for tribal rhythmns, all things Funky; and yes, even jazz, here is a group combining all three elements in a dance that is often exhilarating, sometimes confusing.

Based in Bristol and Cheltenham, and out of the same stable as the innovative Pop Group; Pigbag are six young musicians with the ability and intelligence, to assimilate their influences, experiment, improvise, and turn the result into a music that can be unique, free - flowing and joyous.

Concentrating strictly on their fast and frantic rhythmns, Pigbag use vocals sparingly, most songs being accompanied by "animal" shrieks and growls. A ploy, that is in truth, more annoying than atmospheric, still . . .

At their best; watch Pigbag dancing the stage, working on a riff, hammering on a note, hitting that beat just right and pulling together a sound that excites the feet and moves the heart.

Yet their approach because of its very looseness and spontaneity can sometimes fall apart; the rhythm and purpose fading into a wild cacophony, irritating rather than irresistible.

Because their quest is both great and bold, Pigbag are bound to irritate and annoy. They will make plenty of mistakes, because they don't play safe. Check out their first single 'Pappa's Got A Brand New Pigbag', and go and see them if you have an open mind.

THE ORIGINAL MIRRORS
Edinburgh Nite Club
By Bob Flynn

FILE under 'No Justice'. I was convinced last year that the Original Mirrors would make it with ease and would soon be hanging elegantly around the charts and the concert halls. Wrong. Chronic mishandling and luck leaves them back at square one, decorating the club walls. I took another look in the glass and hoped it wasn't tarnished.

Jumping on stage, they jolt the audience out of their poses with 'Heart Twango And Raw Beat', the title of the new album, a strutting, yelping, Bo Diddley - style start that immediately warmed the place with stage - front fire. Then a flick of the eye to 'Boys Cry', steaming along and knocking all of yer new rockabilly boys into a trashed Cadillac. The gears change from neutral to top as they play, the picture from monochrome to technicolour, the accent on the positive. Style is not confined to the appearance, but contained in their music and that essential quality sets them apart.

All loose ends are tied up into a chunky block of sound as they chop hard into the forthcoming single, '20,000 Dreamers!' The Brylcream bounce of singer Steve Allen disintegrates under the heat but his mighty, expressive voice remains intact, fronting the band with infectious joy. The roof is slowly coming off as they re - work and revitalise the classic Motowner, 'Reflections', giving a depth and feel out of talented strength, echoes up to high heaven then smashing down to a glorious finish. "Good number in'it?" asks Steve in ecstatic understatement.

Stop looking at your own reflection and frame these Mirrors in gold, for if this band is ignored then you can file *that* under Bloody Tragedy.



Pic by Justin Thomas

Adam takes Gilbert and Sullivan one step beyond.

Best fun with clothes on

ADAM AND THE ANTS
Cornwall Coliseum, St Austell
By Nikki Slight

THE GIRLS screamed, the mums smiled, and the Ants delivered.

Britain's favourite pirate couldn't have chosen a more appropriate venue than Cornwall Coliseum, the West Country's wild frontier which literally stands on a beach like an overblown smuggler's cave.

Despite the eyepatch — donned for medical reasons — the Ant king was in a bold, mutineering mood. He opened with a wardance, 'Human Beings', and then went straight into battle.

The Ants' daring set could never have been attempted by a band with lesser confidence. 'Stand And Deliver' was the second number and most of the singles like 'Kings' and 'Antmusic' followed early on.

Adam sends himself up with all the camp cheek of his glam - rock godfather Gary Glitter. But unlike Gary, Adam will never get complacent.

The Ants didn't need to pull any punches and Adam was wearing the only frills in the show. By the first encore they had already pulled out vintage material like 'Press Darlings', 'Cartrouble' and 'Zerox' — but despite their recent return from a long European tour everything was played with astounding verve and freshness.

By the end of the night the dashing Gary Tibbs was becoming more and more animated although all eyes were on Adam who said his farewell with 'You're So Physical' — the third encore.

The Ants are ripe and ready for a backlash. Perhaps it's already started and we're all wondering whether they can maintain their current pitch. For now, have faith and ignore all the ultra - hips preparing to jump ship. This man is a professional. His infectious pride is bolstered by an excellent band who are spot - on with the 'Big Man', Marco, an ideal foil for the swashbuckling beguiler.

Adam makes no promises. It's just antmusic for sex people — the best fun you can have with your clothes on.

The band left a sparkling legacy in this, their last UK appearance before Christmas. The Ant invasion will hit Australia and America in August. If the Yanks aren't turned on they haven't got any switches.